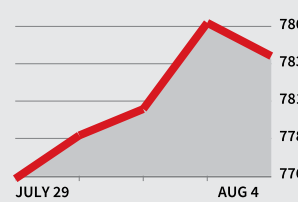


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 78428.95 (-210.08)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24614.90	-159.40
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.92	-0.06
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.37	+0.04
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	142294.00	+308
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	218635.00	+1348

BREAKTHROUGH.

India to grow world's first gene edited rice this winter with the ICAR set to ink a pact with US-based Corteva **p12**



AI EFFECT.

IT firms pivoting to smaller deals to protect margins as clients turn cautious **p14**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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QUICKLY.

SECURITY FEARS

US plans ban on Chinese data centre devices



Washington: The Trump administration is drafting a ban on US imports of new models of Chinese data centre components, four people familiar with the matter told *Reuters*. The FCC is working on the measure to bar imports of new Chinese optical transceivers. **p10**

MOTOR COVER

SC extends third-party insurance for new vehicles

New Delhi: The Supreme Court has extended the mandatory third-party motor insurance period for new vehicles, requiring 4 years of coverage for new cars and six years for new two-wheelers. The court observed that despite the statutory mandate, a “shocking” number of vehicles continued to ply on the roads without third-party insurance, forcing accident victims and their families to “run from pillar to post” to secure compensation. **p9**

Closing auction: Nifty swings on Day 2 raise eyebrows

SURPRISE. Tuesday's auction hits weekly expiry settlements, catching traders off guard

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The sharp swings in the Nifty 50's official closing value for a second straight session on Tuesday have intensified the debate around SEBI's newly introduced Closing Auction Session (CAS), with settlement prices for weekly derivatives expiry getting affected even after regular trading ended.

The Nifty 50 closed at 24,615, down 159 points, or 0.64 per cent. However, the index was trading around 24,463 before the closing auction and gained 151 points during the CAS window. The Sensex, which was less affected by the new mechanism, ended 0.3 per cent lower at 78,429.

On Monday, the first day of CAS, the Nifty jumped nearly 200 points during the auction session. Continuous trading in F&O stocks ends at 3.15 pm, after which their official closing prices are discovered through CAS.

Since settlement of Nifty derivatives is based on the benchmark's official closing



	Spot price	Future price
Nifty	24,614.9	24,555.6
Infosys	1,167.5	1,164.5
TCS	2,460.0	2,457.4
BSE	3,618.0	3,605.2
Nestle	1,520.0	1,489.0

value, Tuesday's auction directly affected weekly expiry settlements, catching many traders off guard.

HIGH VOLATILITY

Under CAS, buy and sell orders are collected after regular trading hours and matched at a single equilibrium price. Limited liquidity and order imbalances can lead to sharp swings in the final settlement price, resulting in heightened volatility.

Traders said the auction altered the expected decay in options premium after 3.15 pm. The Nifty 24,600 put option, which was trading above ₹100 late in the session, expired worthless as

the index settled higher, while the Nifty 24,500 call option rose nearly five-fold by settlement.

Vinod Nair, Head of Research at Geojit Investments, said the gap between the pre-auction and final closing levels of Nifty stocks and the index, along with the divergence from the Sensex, suggest that the new system is creating excessive volatility.

“This has triggered forced square-offs of positions, particularly among retail investors, ahead of the 15-minute blind closing auction window after derivatives trading has ended,” he said.

Nair added that these appeared to be teething issues in the new system and that exchanges and SEBI need to address the discrepancies.

Email queries to SEBI remained unanswered till press time. The back-to-back swings have revived concerns raised during SEBI's consultation process.

While foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) largely supported the move, saying it aligns India's closing process with global markets and be-

nefits passive investors, several domestic brokers and market participants questioned if the liquidity would be sufficient for efficient price discovery.

“Volumes are light as the market is digesting a completely new mechanism. It will take the local community a while to get used to CAS, which is completely in line with what FPIs understand. More the participants get used to the CAS, less will the volatility they will experience,” an FPI source said.

CAUTION URGED

Broking industry body ANMI also urged caution against drawing conclusions from the first two sessions.

“We believe participation will improve over the next few expiry cycles and are engaging with SEBI and the exchanges to strengthen the framework,” ANMI said.

ANMI President Kamlesh Shroff said, “We expect participation and liquidity to improve progressively as brokers, institutional participants and retail investors become more familiar with the process.”

Most labels and ads changed, says Dabur after crackdown by FSSAI on ‘100 per cent’ claims

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

After the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India prohibited the sale of some of its food products over the use of “100 per cent” claims, Dabur India on Tuesday said labels and advertisements for most of the affected products have either already been revised without such claims or are being changed.

The company said it is engaging with the regulator and seeking legal advice on the future course of action.

STANDS FOR QUALITY

“Dabur stands by the purity and quality of its products and has never made any misleading claims. However, as a good corporate citizen, Dabur had already initiated transitioning of the product labels as mentioned in the FSSAI letter to new labels/advertisements without the 100 per cent claim. Most product labels, advertisements and website content referred to in the order have either already transitioned or are in the process of transition,” the company said in a



Dabur is “seeking legal advice” on the future course of action

statement. The issue is essentially one of labelling and advertising claims rather than product safety.

The FSSAI had objected to the use of absolute “100 per cent” claims on the ground that they were unverifiable and potentially misleading, not because the products were found to be unsafe or substandard.

HALT OF SALE

On Monday, the regulator said that some of the food products sold on the company's website were found to be carrying the misleading “100 per cent” claims.

The FSSAI said that it had issued a prohibition of sale

order to Dabur India for food products carrying the “misleading 100 per cent claim” including honey, apple cider vinegar, virgin coconut oil, sesame oil, cow ghee, coconut water and coconut milk, among others.

“The notice relates only to the interpretation of the product description and does not allege or question the quality, safety, purity or standards of the products manufactured or marketed by the company,” Dabur India noted in a BSE filing.

On Tuesday, Dabur India's share price ended at ₹408.25 on BSE, down 3.81 per cent over the previous day's close.

NOTICE TO OTHER COS

In the recent past, the FSSAI had said that it had issued notices over “100 per cent” related claim violations to other players, including Masterchow, Lotte India, Kubera Foods and Dia Foods.

In a separate action, the Central Consumer Protection Authority in June said that it had imposed a penalty on Storia Foods & Beverages and Mrs Bectors Food Specialities for misleading ads with “100 per cent” claims.

Govt moves Bill to levy MDR on UPI, digital payments on big merchants; no fee for consumers

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Any electronic mode of payment outside the negative list notified by the Finance Ministry will attract Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) and one of them could be unified payment interface (UPI), sources have said. The list will be notified once the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill (ToLA) is enacted.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitaraman on Tuesday introduced the ToLA Bill in the Lok Sabha. Apart from various provisions, the Bill aims to also amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007. The amendment prescribes removing the reference of provision of the Income-Tax Act and to provide that “no bank or system pro-



UPI today processes 23 billion interoperable payment transactions every month

vider shall impose, whether directly or indirectly, any charge upon a person making or receiving a payment by using one or more electronic modes of payment as may be notified by the Central government.” Simply put, the Bill will enable the government to notify which instruments, category of people making payment or threshold will be exempted.

However, sources said nothing had been finalised but agreed that the enabling provision will lead the way for MDR. It is a fee paid by merchants to banks and payments service providers for processing digital transactions. While credit cards in India typically attract an MDR of about 1.5 per cent and debit cards up to 0.9 per cent, UPI transactions are currently free for merchants.

TWO OPTIONS

According to reports, the government is considering two options for UPI monetisation: Capping free transactions and charging MDR above a certain threshold or levying a fee based on a merchant's annual turnover. Sources declined to confirm or deny the proposals.

Today, UPI processes nearly 23 billion interoper-

able payment transactions every month. Looking at the near-zero investment scenario over the last six years, the pace of growth is naturally slowing, though there is still an opportunity to increase penetration by 3x across both consumers and merchants.

“For us to get to 90 per cent penetration and to take UPI global, start-ups, fintechs and banks will need to fund this expansion through continued investments in IT, innovation and cyber security. These costs have increased by almost 300 per cent over the last 12-24 months. While there should be some recovery of these investments, P2P transactions — and charges to consumers — should continue to remain zero,” said Amrith Rau, CEO Pine Labs, in a social media post.

India's mobile apps market hits record \$345 m in Q2 2026

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Indian users may finally be paying for app-based services, and the country is evolving from being the world's largest mobile app downloads market into a market that also pays for services, recent data from market intelligence firm Sensor Tower show.

Driven by AI subscriptions, video streaming and digital services, India's mobile app market reached a record \$345 million in Q2 2026 (April-June 2026), up 35 per cent year-on-year from the same quarter last year.

Of this, non-gaming revenue stood at nearly \$240 million and surged more than 50 per cent y-o-y.

Sensor Tower's analysis of the app market takes into account estimated in-app purchase (IAP) revenue from Google Play and the App Store, excluding advertising revenue and revenue from third-party Android app

stores. Thirty-five per cent y-o-y growth is the strongest revenue growth among major mobile markets, outperforming both mature markets such as the US, Japan and South Korea, and large emerging markets including Brazil, Mexico and Indonesia.

PRICING CORRECTLY

Vikas Chawla, Co-founder of digital marketing firm Social Beat, said that app revenue had increased, and is coming from AI and entertainment.

“UPI has reduced friction. Global players have started pricing India correctly. Pricing, especially for AI, finally came down to Indian levels. ₹19 for the next episode, weekly AI tiers instead of annual plans and such,” he said.

He noted that much of the acceleration is coming from AI with ChatGPT and Claude taking roughly 83 per cent of India's AI app revenue.

However, Chawla pointed out that ad revenue and third-party Android stores, which Sensor Tower does



Top apps in Q2

By downloads	By revenues
ChatGPT <i>OpenAI</i>	Google One
Instagram	ChatGPT <i>OpenAI</i>
JioHotstar	Crunchyroll
Meesho	YouTube
Story TV	Claude by Anthropic

not track, are where most Indian apps actually earn.

“India is transitioning from being a download economy to a monetisation economy,” marketing consultant Shubho Sengupta said.

AI chatbots like ChatGPT and Claude ranking among the Top 5 in revenue terms suggested that Indians had taken to productivity through AI tools in a big way, he added.

Video entertainment accounted for half of the top 10 apps of Q2 in India by rev-

enue. Amazon Prime Video (7th) and home-grown platform Jio HotStar (10th spot) were in the top 10 by revenue.

Among generative AI apps, Claude emerged as one of the fastest-growing monetisation stories. ChatGPT was in the second spot by revenue, and Claude in the fifth. “Revenue [of Claude] reached a record high in Q2, increasing more than 19-fold y-o-y, highlighting the growing willingness of Indian users to pay for premium AI services,” said Eve Chen, Insights Analyst, Sensor Tower.

Interestingly, Google One, a paid subscription service that expands cloud storage, was the top app by revenue in Q2, indicating that more people are paying for storage as digital content use grows and Google curbs free storage. TV was the only short drama app in India's Top 10 download ranking in Q2 2026, while reaching a record-high MAU in June, Sensor Tower said.

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Pidilite Industries posts 27.7% jump in Q1 profit



Mumbai: Pidilite Industries reported a 27.7 per cent rise in standalone profit after tax (PAT) to ₹830 crore for the first quarter of FY27 driven by broad-based volume growth and proactive price increases across product categories. Standalone net sales grew 22.2 per cent year-on-year to ₹4,237 crore. On a consolidated basis, the Mumbai-headquartered adhesives and sealants maker posted revenue of ₹4,541 crore, up 21.3 per cent, with PAT rising 30.3 per cent to ₹884 crore. Consolidated EBITDA stood at ₹1,194 crore, a 26.9 per cent increase, with margins expanding to 26.3 per cent from 25.1 per cent in the year-ago period. Standalone EBITDA came in at ₹1,121 crore, up 26.2 per cent, with margins improving approximately 80 basis points to 26.4 per cent. **OUR BUREAU**

Airtel Q1 net profit up 37% on India, Africa business growth

KEY DRIVERS. Subscriber additions and focus on premiumisation in the mobile segment

Our Bureau
Chennai

Bharti Airtel reported 37 per cent growth in net profit at ₹8,167 crore for Q1FY27 on the back of subscriber additions and the telco's continued focus on premiumisation in the mobile segment. Profit, however, missed the consensus estimates of Bloomberg analysts. Consolidated revenues for Q1FY27 stood at ₹58,539 crore, up 18 per cent year-on-year, supported by strong growth across India and Africa operations. India business revenue came in at ₹41,214 crore, up 9.7 per cent. India mobile revenue grew 9.2 per cent, supported by strong customer additions and an improvement in Average Revenue Per User (ARPU). Airtel's ARPU increased to ₹264 in Q1FY27 (₹250). In comparison, its rival Reliance Jio's ARPU stood at

Scorecard			
	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	y-o-y % change
Net profit (₹ crore)	5,948	8,167	37
Revenue (₹ crore)	49,463	58,539	18
ARPU (in ₹)	250	264	5.6

₹215.6 as of June 30. Bharti Airtel also reported the highest-ever quarterly postpaid subscriber additions in Q1FY27 at net additions of one million, thereby reaching a customer base of 30 million. It was during this quarter that the telco launched Postpaid Fast Lane, a premium-tier 5G postpaid connectivity driven by 5G slicing technology, which attracted fair amount of scrutiny and debate around net neutrality norms. Smartphone data customers increased by 21.1 million and now make up 80 per cent of total mobile customers. Mobile data consumption rose 36 per cent, reaching 34.4 GB per customer per month, Airtel said.

“We delivered yet another quarter of strong performance, supported by the resilience of our diversified portfolio and sharp execution across businesses,” Gopal Vittal, Executive Vice-Chairman, said. “During the quarter, we completed a large and an EPS-accretive share-swap transaction to increase our stake in Airtel Africa to over 79 per cent. This is a reflection of our conviction in Africa's long-term growth potential and the significant opportunities across our businesses.”

BUSINESS GROWTH Africa Business ended the quarter with a customer base of 189 million and delivered

strong revenue growth of 21 per cent in Constant Currency. Consolidated EBITDA came in at ₹33,599 crore with margin of 57.4 per cent. India EBITDA was at ₹24,781 crore; EBITDA margin was at 60.1 per cent. Airtel's Homes segment also delivered robust revenue growth of 33.2 per cent, supported by continued expansion of the customer base. During the quarter, the company added 4.73 lakh customers, taking the customer base in the segment to 14.7 million. Airtel Business delivered a 12 per cent revenue growth, supported by steady growth in connectivity solutions and sustained strong momentum across digital services portfolio. Digital TV revenues saw marginal 1.4 per cent growth. Bharti Airtel's consolidated capex during the quarter stood at ₹13,386 crore, of which India capex accounted for ₹9,698 crore.

LIC's investment portfolio shifts decisively away from loans

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

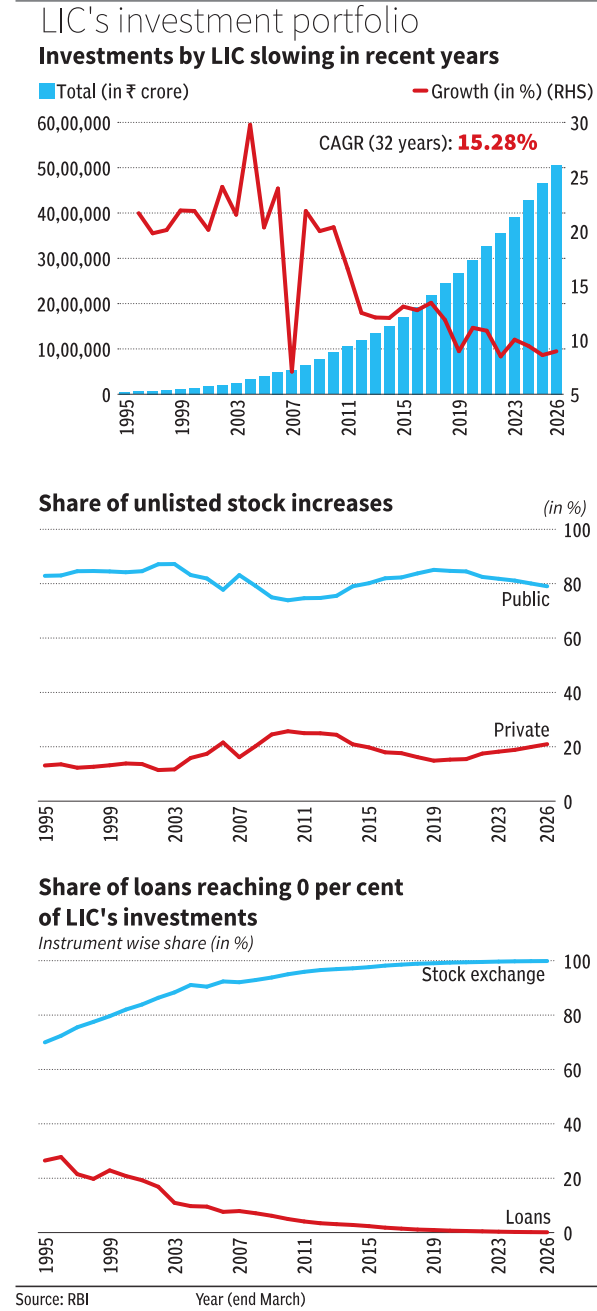
The Government of India's announcement of the offer for sale (OFS) of equity shares in the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) renewed investor attention on the country's largest institutional investor and the composition of its massive investment portfolio.

DATA FOCUS.

Data from RBI's Handbook of Statistics show that LIC's total investments reached ₹50.66 lakh crore at the end of March 2026, almost doubling from ₹26.62 lakh crore in March 2019. However, the data also point to two important structural trends: The pace of portfolio growth has moderated in recent years, while the share of investments in private, largely unlisted, companies has gradually increased.

GROWTH SLOWS LIC's investment portfolio has expanded at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 15.3 per cent over the past three decades, rising from ₹53,480 crore in March 1995 to more than ₹50 lakh crore by March 2026. Annual growth, which routinely exceeded 20 per cent during much of the late 1990s and early 2000s, has remained below 10 per cent in each of the last five years. Its investment mix, too, has gradually shifted. The share of investments in public listed companies has eased to 79 per cent in 2026 from over 85 per cent in the mid-1990s, while the share of investments in private companies has climbed to 21 per cent, its highest level in the series.

EQUITIES DOMINATE Our analysis also shows a decisive transformation in the



type of financial instruments held by LIC. Investments through stock exchange accounted for 99.88 per cent of the portfolio in March 2026, up from 70 per cent in 1995. The share of loans has steadily declined from 26.5 per cent three decades ago to just 0.12 per cent. The shift underscores LIC's shift from lending to companies under distress towards better management of its portfolio. As of June 30, 2026, LIC holds 6.88 per cent of total shares in RIL, 11.73 per cent of shares in Infosys, 5.52 per cent of shares in TCS, 4.77 per cent of shares in HDFC Bank and 6.59 per cent of shares in HUL.

Hyundai Motor India targets 8-10% growth in FY27

Our Bureau
Chennai

Hyundai Motor India (HMI) outlined an ambitious roadmap for FY27, targeting 8-10 per cent growth across its domestic and export businesses, while planning to invest around ₹7,500 crore to strengthen manufacturing capacity, introduce new products and modernise its production facilities, the company said in its FY26 annual report. A significant portion of the FY27 investment will be towards upcoming vehicle

launches, capacity expansion and plant upgrades, as Hyundai seeks to enhance its competitiveness in both the domestic and export markets, the report said. The company said the growth outlook is supported by improving market conditions, a robust product pipeline and an expanding global footprint. It expects to maintain EBITDA margins in the 11-14 per cent range despite the planned investments, reflecting its focus on financial discipline and operational efficiency. In FY27, Hyundai will strengthen its sport utility



vehicle (SUV) portfolio with the launch of two all-new models—a dedicated mass-market electric SUV with high levels of localisation and a new internal combustion engine (ICE) SUV. Hyundai also plans to accelerate electric mobility through greater localisation, expansion of charging infrastruc-

ture and development of the broader EV ecosystem. **MANUFACTURING** On manufacturing, the company said its Chennai plant continues to be its largest production base with an installed annual capacity of 8.24 lakh units. The Talegaon facility in Pune, which commenced production in October 2025, has added another 1.7 lakh units of annual capacity, taking HMI's total installed capacity in India to around one million units a year. The Pune facility will be expanded in phases to 3.2 lakh units annually.

HMI achieved 83 per cent localisation at the OEM level during FY26, reducing import dependence and generating savings through parts localisation and value engineering initiatives. The company expects exports to remain a key growth driver after recording shipments of 190,125 vehicles and contributing 26 per cent of revenue in FY26. HMI said it would enhance export competitiveness through its Chennai and Pune plants while expanding into newer markets, particularly across Latin America, Africa and the Asia-Pacific region.

Amid short-term headwinds, Nestle India says it remains confident of medium- to long-term growth

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Nestle India, on Tuesday, said while there are concerns around geopolitical and inflationary headwinds, it remains confident about navigating short-term challenges, given lower penetration of its categories, headroom for growth in rural regions and strengthening of premiumisation trends. Stating that “overall consumption could moderate in the short term”, in an investor presentation, the company added that West Asia conflict and potential El-Nino impact on monsoons remain key monitorables for F&B sector growth. Speaking at an investors call, Manish Tiwary, Chairman and Managing Director, Nestle India, said: “There are a few headwinds...there is a little bit of impact on food inflation. We are seeing a slow-down in market growth as re-

“If you look at the last few quarters, we have moved into double-digit volume growth consistently”

MANISH TIWARY
CMD, Nestle India

ported by Nielsen. Given where we are on our journey in terms of penetration, rural growth and premiumisation, I remain quite confident of our ability to navigate these short-term blips.” He noted that the geopolitical situation in West Asia is driving up costs of energy, packaging materials and edible oils, besides causing shipping disruptions and currency volatility. Tiwary said the company is deploying value-chain productivity measures to mitigate the impact.



that our growth is broad-based supported by our strong brands, distribution width and accelerating household penetration,” he added. **RURAL REACH** The company said that it is deepening rural reach with total coverage at 2.19 lakh villages by FY26. Tiwary said the contribution of “rural segment” for the company is lower than its peers. “Rural has been one of the more resilient parts of the market when compared to urban. We have the brands, the proposition, the reach and packs at relevant price points. What we are eager to see that rural grows faster than urban, and that's what is more important and it is doing that...” he stated. The packaged food major said its premium portfolio's contribution has risen to 14 per cent by FY26-end and has been growing at a 17 per cent CAGR since 2021.

Marico Q1 profit jumps 25% on strong India volume growth, steady global expansion

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Marico reported a 25 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated profit after tax to ₹630 crore for Q1FY27, its highest PAT growth in 28 quarters, driven by robust volume performance in the India business and steady international expansion. Consolidated revenue from operations grew 23 per cent to ₹3,957 crore from ₹3,221 crore in the year-ago period, the FMCG company said in its quarterly results announcement. EBITDA rose 25 per cent to ₹819 crore, with margins expanding 40 basis points to 20.7 per cent, supported by softer copra prices and a more profitable product mix. Advertising and promotional spends also increased 25 per cent, as the company continued to invest behind its brand portfolio. The India business, which



Scorecard			
	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	% change
Net profit (₹ crore)	504	630	25
Revenue from operations (₹ crore)	3,221	3,957	23

accounted for revenue of ₹3,003 crore, up 21 per cent, posted domestic volume growth of 11 per cent, the highest in 20 quarters. The company said over 96 per cent of its domestic business either gained or sustained market share on a moving annual total basis. E-commerce grew at an accelerated pace, with quick commerce clocking over 50 per cent growth. Parachute Rigid, the company's flagship coconut oil brand, reported 10 per cent volume growth and 23 per cent revenue growth, reaching a record 59 per cent volume market share.

Value-Added Hair Oils posted 22 per cent value growth, while the Foods portfolio expanded 43 per cent, crossing an annualised revenue run-rate of ₹1,300 crore, led by Saffola Oats, Soya Chunks and Muesli. The recently-acquired brands 4700BC and Cosmix delivered sequential growth in the quarter. The Premium Personal Care portfolio, including digital-first brands, recorded an annualised revenue run-rate of over ₹1,100 crore.

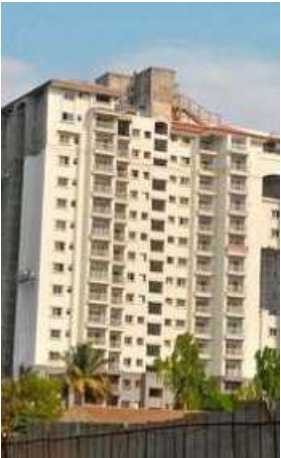
INTERNATIONAL BIZ The International business delivered 15 per cent con-

stant currency growth. Vietnam led with 27 per cent CCG, followed by MENA at 24 per cent and South Africa at 8 per cent. Bangladesh, the largest international market, grew at a more moderate 4 per cent due to pricing anniversary effects and demand softness linked to elevated inflation. On the input cost front, copra prices declined 29 per cent and are expected to remain broadly range-bound, providing some relief against inflation in crude-linked and packaging materials such as liquid paraffin, which rose 97 per cent, and HDPE, which was up 65 per cent. Saugata Gupta, MD and CEO, said the company was confident of crossing the ₹15,000-crore revenue mark in FY27, with expectations of high single-digit volume growth in India, mid-teens constant currency growth internationally and high-teen EBITDA growth for the full year.

Godrej Properties Q1 profit drops 42 per cent

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Godrej Properties reported a sharp decline in profitability for Q1FY27, with net profit after tax falling 42 per cent year-on-year to ₹350 crore from ₹600 crore in Q1 FY26. Total income contracted 16 per cent to ₹1,337 crore (₹1,593 crore). The management, however, characterised the earnings decline as a timing issue rather than a demand problem. “The decline in Q1 FY27 revenue, EBITDA and net profit was primarily timing and accounting driven rather than demand driven,” the company said. Godrej Properties follows the project completion method of revenue recognition, under which revenues are booked only when a project receives its occupancy certificate. In Q1 FY27, only one project received an occu-



pancy certificate — Godrej Palm Retreat in Noida. The profit before tax fell 44 per cent to ₹480 crore, while EBITDA declined 40 per cent to ₹545 crore. Adjusted EBITDA margin contracted sharply to 41.7 per cent (58.1 per cent). The company attributed the fall in revenue recognition

primarily to lower deliveries in the quarter, with only 0.9 million sq ft delivered. **BOOKINGS ROBUST** On the operational side, the picture was notably stronger. Booking value, the total contracted value of apartments and plots sold during the period, net of cancellations, rose 22 per cent to ₹8,651 crore across 3,738 units and 6.2 million sq ft, marking the sixth consecutive quarter with bookings exceeding ₹7,000 crore. Customer collections, which represent actual cash received from buyers against bookings irrespective of when those bookings were made, grew 18 per cent to ₹4,348 crore. The standout launch was Godrej Vanantara in Bengaluru, which clocked bookings of ₹3,237 crore. Net debt rose to ₹7,637 crore as of June 30, 2026, pushing the net debt-to-equity ratio to 0.39. Con-

struction and related outflows surged 54 per cent to ₹2,244 crore, the company said, reflecting accelerated execution activity expected to translate into deliveries in FY28. Operating cash flow for the quarter stood at ₹399 crore, down sharply from ₹4,631 crore in Q4 FY26, largely due to the steep drop in collections following the low-delivery quarter. **EXPANSION PIPELINE** The company added three new projects in Q1 FY27 with an estimated saleable area of 8 million sq ft and expected booking value of ₹9,500 crore, including a large group housing project in Greater Noida DMIC. Against its full-year FY27 guidance of ₹39,000 crore in booking value, the company has achieved 22 per cent in the first quarter. The management maintained all guidance parameters as on track.

Sundram Fasteners' Q1 consolidated PAT up 14%

Our Bureau
Chennai

Sundram Fasteners, the Chennai-based automotive component supplier, reported a 14 per cent increase in net profit for the June quarter at ₹169 crore as against ₹148 crore for the same period last year. The company's consolidated revenue from operations was at ₹1,846 crore (₹1,533 crore), a growth of 20 per cent. On a standalone basis, the net profit was ₹151 crore (₹138 crore) on revenue from operations at ₹1,615 crore (₹1,350 crore), up 20 per cent. Domestic sales were at ₹1,084 crore (₹931 crore), a growth of 16 per cent. Export sales were at ₹466 crore (₹379 crore), up 23 per cent, said the release. Arathi Krishna, Managing Director, Sundram Fasteners, said the company has entered the new financial



year on a strong footing, buoyed by improving business conditions across key markets and the enduring confidence of the customers. “Despite a dynamic global environment, we are encouraged by the steady recovery in export demand and the continued resilience of domestic markets. We are also making steady progress in expanding our presence across high-potential non-automotive sectors such as aerospace, wind energy, railways and defence,” she said. **CAPITAL EXPENDITURE** To drive long-term growth, the company has earmarked capital expenditure of ₹400 crore towards capacity expansion initiatives. These investments are expected to significantly enhance the company's capabilities to address increasing customer requirements across various segments, including Internal Combustion Engine

gineered assemblies, the release said. **EV MARKET** In the global automotive market, there are continuously emerging trends in mobility. Although US OEMs have started to concentrate more on hybrids, their counterparts in Europe are rapidly moving towards the use of EVs. The company is well-placed to leverage these emerging opportunities through its wide range of products and established customer relationships, the company said.

businessline.

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Emami Q1 PAT down 15% at ₹138.94 crore on higher input costs

WAR IMPACT. The costs increased, driven by higher crude oil prices and inflation across packaging materials and several other key inputs, said the company

Our Bureau
Kolkata

FMCG maker Emami reported around a 15 per cent year-on-year fall in its consolidated net profit to ₹138.94 crore for the first quarter this fiscal, as higher input costs due to the West

The company had posted a net profit of ₹164.26 crore for the first quarter last fiscal. Its revenue from operations grew around 15 per cent to ₹1,039.21 crore (₹904.09 crore).

cent, while the international business declined 12 percent due to the West Asia disruptions. "On profitability, the quarter witnessed one of the sharpest inflationary environments seen by the sector in recent years. Input costs rose, driven by higher crude oil prices and inflation across packaging materials

and other key inputs. As a result, gross margins contracted 360 basis points to 65.8 per cent," it said, adding that despite this, EBITDA grew 6 per cent to ₹226 crore.

The company's total expenses rose around 18 per cent at ₹813.03 crore, in which the cost of materials

consumed witnessed an increase of over 30 per cent.

OPTIMISTIC OUTLOOK

The company said it is optimistic about its growth prospects. Q2FY27 is expected to benefit from healthy demand trends across the portfolio and continued momentum in the strategic in-

Harsha V Agarwal, Vice-Chairman and Managing Director, Emami, said, "We delivered another quarter of strong performance despite a challenging operating environment marked by geopolitical disruptions, elevated inflationary pressures and an uneven summer sea-

son across markets. Our domestic business grew 20 per cent, driving overall revenue growth of 15 per cent, reflecting the strength of our brands and execution capabilities.”

Mohan Goenka, Vice-Chairman and Whole-Time Director, said the quarter tested the resilience of the

company's operating model as high input costs continued to exert pressure on margins. "Despite this, our focus on disciplined execution, cost optimisation and operational agility enabled us to deliver EBITDA growth of 6 per cent to ₹226 crore and PBT growth of 4 per cent to ₹195 crore," Goenka added.

Zyduz Wellness Q1 profit falls 7% to ₹119 crore

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Zydus Wellness, the consumer health and wellness arm of the Zydus Group, reported a 7 per cent year-on-year decline in consolidated net profit to ₹119 crore in Q1 FY27. The company, however, posted strong operational growth, with consolidated net sales rising 66.7 per cent to ₹1,430 crore from ₹858 crore in the year-ago period. EBITDA stood at ₹242 crore, registering 55.3 per cent growth, supported by higher contribution from its core brands across the sugar substitutes, nutrition, skincare and personal care categories.

The company said its flagship brand Sugar Free strengthened its leadership in the sugar substitute category with a 96.1 per cent market share, according to Nielsen data, with Sugar Free D'Lite and I'm Lite delivering double-digit growth. Gluco-D maintained its leadership position in the glucose category with a 59.1 per cent market share, while RiteBite Max Protein continued to lead the nutrition protein bars, cookies and chips segment on the back of sustained business performance.

Nutralite delivered double-digit growth during the quarter and retained its leadership position in the fat spreads category, according to company estimates.

In personal care, Everyuth maintained its leadership position in the scrubs and peel-off categories with market shares of 49.4 per cent and 75.5 per cent, respectively. It improved its ranking in the facial cleansing segment, moving to fourth place with an 8.2 per cent market share. Nycil retained its leadership in the prickly heat category with a 32.9 per cent market share, while Cuticolor's performance was driven by strong consumer demand across organised retail channels. Despite a decline in the broader nutritional drinks category, Compland continued its growth momentum and maintained its fourth rank, the company added.



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CRP CSA -XVI

COMMON RECRUITMENT PROCESS (CRP) FOR RECRUITMENT OF CUSTOMER SERVICE ASSOCIATES (CSA) IN PARTICIPATING PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS (Vacancies of 2027-28)

Official Website: www.ibps.in
In case of queries / complaints please log in to <http://cgrrs.ibps.in>

The Online Examination (Preliminary and Main) for the upcoming Common Recruitment Process (CRP CSA-XVI) for Recruitment and Selection of Customer Service Associate (CSA) Post in the Participating Public Sector Banks is tentatively scheduled as:

IMPORTANT DATES	
Activity	Timeline
Online Registration by Candidates	01.08.2026 to 21.08.2026
Payment of Application Fees/ Intimation Charges	01.08.2026 to 21.08.2026
Edit Window for Candidates to Modify/ Correct Application Form (including online payment for Edit)	After closure of Registration (will be notified on Official IBPS website)
Conduct of Pre-Examination Training (PET)	September, 2026
Online Examination – Preliminary	October, 2026
Result of Online Examination – Preliminary	November, 2026
Online Examination – Main	December, 2026
Provisional Allotment	March, 2027

Candidates are advised to regularly visit the official IBPS website www.ibps.in for details and updates.

Candidates intending to apply for CRP CSA XVI are advised to read the detailed Notification carefully and ensure that they fulfil the minimum eligibility criteria on the stipulated dates before registering online. Candidates must follow the instructions mentioned in the detailed Notification.

Mumbai
Date: 01.08.2026

DIRECTOR

Sundram Fasteners Limited

CIN: L35999TN1962PLC004943

Registered & Corporate Office: 98-A, VII Floor, Dr Radhakrishnan Salai, Mylapore, Chennai - 600 004

Tel: +91 - 44 - 28478500 | Fax: 91 - 44 - 28478510

Email: investorshelpdesk@sfl.co.in | Website: www.sundram.com

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ in Crores)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
		Quarter ended		Year ended	Quarter ended		Year ended
		30.06.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026	30.06.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026
		(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1	Total Revenue from Operations	1,614.76	1,350.17	5,542.06	1,846.07	1,533.39	6,288.82
2	Net Profit for the period (before tax and exceptional item)	203.23	185.68	749.63	223.54	199.13	801.18
3	Net Profit for the period (before tax)	203.23	185.68	767.41	223.54	199.13	788.07
4	Net Profit for the period (after tax)	150.97	138.35	580.38	168.69	147.94	592.85
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	151.97	139.87	576.54	175.88	155.27	633.76
6	Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Re 1/- each fully paid up)	21.01	21.01	21.01	21.01	21.01	21.01
7	Earnings Per Share (EPS) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (Face value of Re 1/- each) (not annualised) (in Rs.) (a) Basic (b) Diluted	7.18 7.18	6.58 6.58	27.62* 27.62*	8.01 8.01	7.06 7.06	28.13* 28.13*

* Annualised

Note:

- The above is an extract of the detailed format of the standalone and consolidated financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites, www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and on the Company's website www.sundram.com. The full financial results can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below.
- The Statutory Auditors have carried out a limited review for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 and have issued an unmodified review report thereon.

For Sundram Fasteners Limited

Suresh Krishna
Chairman

Place : Chennai
Date : August 4, 2026

manipalhospitals
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Boom and bust

S Korea's AI meltdown underscores global fragility

A 44-per cent correction in South Korea's benchmark Kospi index, over 50 per cent of which was made up by just 2 AI semiconductor stocks — Samsung and SK Hynix — from its peak of 9,386 on June 19 to a low of 5,263 on July 29, has permanently altered the lives, and economics, of millions of South Koreans. While India has so far managed well, given the lack of an AI bubble here and superior regulation, it is now time for investors and regulators to be on extra guard. The ramifications for financial flows and stability need to be reckoned with as well.

That the financials of AI were in 'Jenga' mode is well known. Even before the correction took a harsh turn in the second half of July, per a Goldman Sachs report, as of July 13 over 1.2 million leveraged retail trading accounts in South Korea had triggered margin calls. Apparently, this represented around 3.4 per cent of the adult population in South Korea. The numbers would have been higher by end of the month. Such was the meltdown that the finance minister of the country had to apologise for giving green light for launch of speculative products like single-stock leveraged ETFs that amplify returns on the upside and downside. While darling semiconductor stock SK Hynix fell by around 50 per cent between June 19 and July 30, the single-stock leveraged ETF indexed to it plunged over 80 per cent.

For now, the issue appears to have been contained, notwithstanding the spectacular blow up of a multi-billion-dollar AI theme focused US hedge fund — Situational Awareness. But global investors and regulators should be alert to concentration risk at various levels. For one, the AI theme has now become too big to fail. The US Big Techs and AI companies are estimated to invest over a trillion dollars in capex in CY26, much of it in the US and the trend is expected to continue for next few years. Two, the wealth effect of stock market boom there, driven by the AI stocks too, has been a big support in driving the K-shaped economy where consumption has been driven just by the top half of the population. Three, within the stock market boom and wealth effect lurks a bubble — with the S&P 500 trading at a PE of 33 times CY25 earnings, even higher than its PE of 30 times during the dot com bubble. The risk here is how much hinges on just few companies. For example, in CY26, a few AI companies that make up just 2 per cent of S&P 500 companies are expected to drive 33 per cent of the earnings growth.

Thus, a triple whammy lurks if the AI boom hits a speed bump — a slowdown in capex triggering a US economic slowdown, severe market correction from bubble valuations, and financial and trade shocks. If this materialises, then it will have collateral damage in rest of the world, including in India. India has so far managed well, given the absence of an AI bubble here — thanks to lack of AI stocks to invest, and superior regulation. It is important to have adequate risk guardrails for a bubble-break scenario.

POCKET RAVIKANTH



On July 14, 2026, the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) released a consultation paper proposing that companies list equity shares on GIFT City exchanges without a traditional public offer. It cites Spotify, Slack, and Coinbase as precedents and sets a minimum post-listing market capitalisation of \$50 million. But the more consequential question it raises is why, after six years of institution-building, GIFT City still has no secondary equity market with assets that foreign investors choose to hold within it for its own sake.

Examining the GIFT City markets ecosystem, the key figures are familiar but worth restating. As of March 2026, the assets of the International Banking Unit reached \$111 billion, up from \$88.51 billion in March 2025, a rise of about 25.4 per cent year-on-year. Fund Management Entities grew from 162 to 217 within this period, and registered funds or schemes totalled 360. Non-retail schemes raised a total of \$39.09 billion in commitments, compared to \$15.74 billion a year earlier — an increase of roughly 148 per cent. However, the data on capital deployment highlights the underlying structure: \$15.36 billion of investments went into India and \$1.59 billion abroad, totalling \$16.95 billion. GIFT City efficiently channels capital, but unless it generates assets held by foreign investors, it remains a corridor rather than a true market..

IFSCA's efforts to build a listed equity market have met a lukewarm response, and the reason is structural. Currency and commodity derivatives at GIFT City faced a market already served by CME Group, ICE, and LME — venues with decades of incumbency that regulation cannot replicate. The equity secondary market faces the same problem: intermediaries at GIFT IFSC — custodians, depository participants, and broker-dealers — exist only as a framework and are very thin in practice. The regulation is present; the global-standard plumbing is not.

THE COLD-START PROBLEM
The direct listing paper, as mentioned in the consultation paper, starts from the harder end. An unlisted company arriving at GIFT City has no price history, no index membership, and no existing shareholder base. Foreign institutional allocators deploy through screens that require trading history, analyst coverage, and liquidity

Why GIFT City needs to enable dual listing

GLOBAL COMPETENCE. It will help attract foreign investors, and thereby position GIFT City as a favoured choice for cross-border equity access in Asia



benchmarks. A company meeting a \$50 million capitalisation threshold at listing may not pass any of those filters on day one. Direct listing of unlisted issuers is a building block; it could not be a foundation for a secondary equity market.

Instead, dual listing enables companies already traded on NYSE, Nasdaq, or LSE to also list at GIFT City using a fungible share or depository receipt. The investor base is established, and prices are already determined in a robust primary market. Companies have already filed disclosures under IFRS or US GAAP. This approach doesn't require capital to discover new information; instead, it allows existing holders of a known instrument to transact at GIFT

Dual listing enables companies already traded on NYSE, Nasdaq, or LSE to also list at GIFT City using a fungible share or depository receipt

City, leveraging a time-zone advantage.

The evidence worldwide is clear. Alibaba's secondary listing in Hong Kong in November 2019 raised \$11.3 billion and achieved a first-day trading volume of \$1.78 billion, accounting for over 10 per cent of HKEX's total that day. By mid-2022, the average daily trading volume in Hong Kong was \$0.7 billion, compared to \$3.2 billion in the US. This represents about 22 per cent of global trading volume, offering Asian investors access to a familiar market for a stock they already owned. The London Stock Exchange's International Secondary Listings category allows non-UK companies to access London markets without bearing full UK disclosure requirements — which is a model IFSCA could consider adopting.

COLLATERAL UPSIDE
A dual-listed equity market at GIFT City would benefit more than just the exchange. Custodians managing foreign-investor holdings require dollar-denominated infrastructure, daily MTM reporting, and standard

Rising temperature hurts labour productivity

Heat reduces the efficiency of today's workers, and can weaken the learning and capabilities of tomorrow's workforce

Santosh Kumar Dash
Dinabandhu Sethi

In recent years, temperatures have routinely spiked above 45 degrees Celsius across various regions in India. As extreme heat becomes more common, its consequences are likely to extend beyond environmental challenges to macroeconomics, productivity, and human capital outcomes.

Heat weakens labour efficiency, reduces manufacturing output, and can intensify food inflation by affecting agricultural production. In an influential study, Dell *et al* (2009) showed that hotter countries tend to be poorer, with each 1°F increase in average temperature associated with 4.5 per cent lower GDP per capita.

Recent research by economists Bilal and Kanzig, published in the *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, shows that a permanent 1°C rise in global temperature lowers global GDP by 20 per cent in the long run.

A recent study by Somanathan *et al* (2021) published in the *Journal of Political Economy* shows that Indian manufacturing output declines by nearly 2 per cent annually for a 1°C rise in temperature. In a nationally representative panel of 58,000 manufacturing plants from the Annual Survey of India, the study found that high temperatures erode work efficiency by increasing heat stress. Also, rising temperatures cause increased workplace

absenteeism, particularly in factories without adequate climate control. This directly lowers labour productivity.

This evidence is observed at the worker and factory levels across industries such as cloth weaving, garment sewing, and steel products. Worker-level data reveal that an additional day of hotter days in a week reduces daily work efficiency by 8 per cent in the garment industry in the National Capital Region without a climate control facility. In Surat's cloth-weaving industry, additional hot days above 35°C reduce output by 2.7 per cent. At the district level, the study recorded a higher decline in output (3.5 per cent) in the manufacturing GDP data. The ILO (2019) report suggests that India is among the countries most severely affected by heat stress, estimating that the country could lose 5.8 per cent of working hours in 2030.

HIGH EXPOSURE TO HEAT
One unintended consequence of rising heat may be higher substitution of labour with machines. As temperatures soar, firms exposed to high temperatures will prefer to deploy more machines or robots to sustain the productivity and meet deadlines.

Can excess heat affect the cognitive performance of kids of agricultural households? Yes, economists Garg, Maulik, and Taraz found high temperatures reduce math and reading test scores among school-age children. The authors argue that agricultural income explains this relationship. When



LABOUR LAWS. Heat-stress standards are yet to be defined

higher-than-normal temperatures over a longer-run horizon reduces income from agriculture by lowering labour efficiency, households dependent on this sector gets lower income and so, invest low on education.

Heat, therefore, affects productivity in two ways: it reduces the efficiency of today's workers and can weaken the learning and capabilities of tomorrow's workforce.

The productivity costs of a warming climate cannot be ignored by an economy hoping to grow quickly and steadily. The policy implications are substantial.

First, the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020 was a significant consolidation of labour law. While the code gives the Central Government the power to prescribe ventilation, temperature, and humidity standards, national heat-stress standards are yet to be defined in the code. Evidence-based heat-stress

margin. These enhancements would elevate GIFT City's custody services from a licensed setup to a globally operational business. Depository participants would handle DVP (delivery versus payment) transactions, which are absent in a derivatives-dominated marketplace. Broker-dealers would establish research and market-making desks aligned with the Asia-Europe time zone. Meanwhile, legal and fintech firms specialising in multi-jurisdictional disclosure and order routing would find a strong commercial base in GIFT City, rather than in Singapore or Dubai. Ecosystem growth depends on ongoing, commercially viable activity driven by consistent demand for services.

WHAT IFSCA MUST NOW DO
IFSCA should develop a dual listing framework that runs in parallel, featuring an International Secondary Listings category. This category would require a qualifying primary listing on a recognised global exchange, along with IFRS/USGAAP financial statements. It should also include a fungible mechanism to prevent price divergence. A simple information document — rather than a full prospectus — should be acceptable if the primary exchange mandates continuous disclosure. Settlement must align with global prime-brokerage standards, including T+1 in dollar, DVP-based clearing, seamless Central Securities Depository (CSD) connectivity, and integration with global custodians. Finally, bilateral regulatory cooperation/understanding with home-market regulators must be established before any dual-listed company begins trading.

GIFT City was envisioned as a marketplace rather than a simple pass-through. The recent listing announcement indicates IFSCA recognises what yet needs to be addressed. Enabling dual listings of internationally traded securities brings proven liquidity, enhances the ecosystem, and provides foreign investors with an equity asset class within GIFT City jurisdiction that is worth holding and trading in the Indian time zone.

The intermediary community at GIFT IFSC must develop true global competence — not just be licensed but meet the high standards expected by sovereign wealth funds and pension managers. IFSCA should establish binding benchmarks for settlement timelines, reporting standards, and system integration. Ultimately, dual listing, globally capable intermediaries, and a regulatory regime will position GIFT City as the first choice for cross-border equity access in the Asian time zone.

The writer is Partner, MCQube

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Banker-client relationship
With reference to "Relationship banking" (August 4), the fear of large-scale impersonation and misrepresentation by third parties and the imminent legal challenges involved, banker-client relationship is gradually moving from trust to authorisation mode. The DPPD framework and rules have come to the timely rescue of bankers in safeguarding their interest through streamlined systems and processes, whereby the proper authenticity of transactions are established digitally,

which further facilitates compliance of governance and audit requirements. Customer awareness must be enhanced before risk preventive tools are introduced.
Sitaram Popuri
Bengaluru

Uplift of contract workers
Apropos 'How India's contract labour framework is changing' (August 4), contract workers play a massive role in sectors such as manufacturing, construction, logistics and services. But they often

face issues related to fair wages, job security and lack of social protection. The new framework and labour codes seek to ensure better social security, timely payment of wages and improved working conditions for contract workers. Despite these positive changes effective implementation remains a challenge. Strict enforcement is needed to prevent exploitation. A balanced contract labour system that protects workers' rights while supporting industrial growth is essential for our economic growth.

Employers, contractors and government agencies must work together to ensure the intended benefits reach each and every worker.
Bal Govind
Noida

Factory output buoyant
This refers to 'Growth engine' (August 4). The IIP readings for Q1 of FY26-27 have shown surprising buoyancy. The June reading is a two-year high and this is despite the doom and gloom predictions of

most economists and bankers when the war in West Asia erupted. The data reveals broad based growth across most segments including capital goods. This is a relief and confirms the growing resilience of the Indian economy despite deep oil price and supply shocks. However this is not the time for overconfidence and celebration since the crisis has exposed several gaps in our preparedness including low oil and cooking gas stocks.
Pradip Menon
Kochi

Hurdles to innovation

Governance and absorption capacity pose concerns

Subash S.
Sunil Mani

India's innovation story has become one of the country's quiet success stories. It has taken rapid strides in publication output and patents filed, with its ranking climbing to 81 from 138 in the Global Innovation Index.

Yet there is a paradox at the heart of this success story. India continues to produce impressive scientific and technological outputs while investing relatively little in R&D. Gross Expenditure on Research and Development (GERD) has remained stuck at around 0.64 per cent of GDP for almost a decade. More importantly, researchers increasingly point to an institutional environment that often makes doing research unnecessarily difficult.

Two studies — one, by Indian National Science Academy (INSA), the National Academy of Sciences, India (NASI), and NITI Aayog, and the other by NITI Aayog's report, Ease of Doing Research and Development in India — bring this problem into sharp focus.

India's challenge is not a shortage of scientific talent. It is the difficulty of converting that talent into sustained scientific and technological capability.

If there is one statistic that captures the problem, it is the time researchers spend waiting. According to the INSA-NASI-NITI Aayog survey, researchers wait an average of seven months simply to learn whether a grant proposal has been approved.

Once approved, sanction orders may take another six months, or even longer, to arrive. Funds that lapse at the end of a financial year often take months to be restored. Final project payments may remain pending for more than a year. The cumulative effect is striking. In a five-year research project, administrative delays can consume well over two years.

The NITI Aayog report proposes procedural reforms. Yet digital portals and simplified procedures cannot by themselves change a bureaucratic culture in which officials are often rewarded for avoiding mistakes rather than enabling research. The problem is not only process; it is incentives.

The most ambitious recommendation in the NITI Aayog report is to increase India's GERD from around 0.6-0.7 per cent of GDP to 2 per cent within the next four to five years.



INNOVATION. Fostering an ecosystem /ISTOCKPHOTO

India's research challenge is not simply a shortage of money. It is equally a problem of governance and absorption capacity.

PRIVATE SECTOR MISSING In most OECD economies, industry finances more than 70 per cent of national R&D expenditure. In India, the figure remains around 36 per cent. Yet the gap cannot be bridged merely through tax incentives and exhortation.

The challenge, therefore, is not persuading researchers to work with industry. It is creating an industrial ecosystem willing to invest in research in the first place.

The NITI Aayog report reveals another uncomfortable reality: India increasingly resembles a two-speed research system.

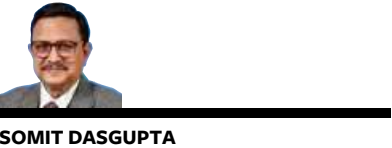
At one end are elite institutions such as the IITs and the Indian Institute of Science, which dominate patenting, commercialisation, and advanced research output. At the other end are hundreds of state universities that account for the bulk of higher education enrolment but contribute relatively little to research.

A more durable solution requires strengthening research capacity within state universities.

One of the most underappreciated barriers to innovation lies in the incentives facing universities. Yet the deeper issue is that universities are rewarded primarily for publications rather than innovation. Although NIRF includes patents and intellectual property indicators, its ranking methodology places much greater weight on publications and citations than on technology commercialisation.

The result is predictable: India produces research papers at scale but struggles to convert knowledge into commercially valuable technologies.

Subash is Professor of Economics at IIT-Madras; Mani is Visiting Professor Ahmedabad University



SOMIT DASGUPTA

The Indian space sector has been in the news recently. A launch vehicle made in the private sector has successfully put a payload in the desired orbit. Not only that, it did so in its very first attempt which was not achieved even by Elon Musk's Space X.

This feat is a classic case of public-private partnership since the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) did all the hand holding including providing its infrastructure for the launch. It will take a while for the private sector to break the umbilical chord from ISRO and handle all the operations independently using its own infrastructure.

Incidentally, in the US, all the private space operators function independently of the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA).

The Indian space sector was thrown open to the private sector in 2020 and there are about 400 start-ups already up and about. The total business, it is estimated to be around \$8.4 billion today which is about 2-3 per cent of the world market. Prior to 2020, the Indian space programme was solely led by ISRO. ISRO was set up in 1969 to develop and apply space technology for various national needs. The government decided to rope in the private sector for various reasons.

The first and foremost is that the government was desirous of getting additional financial resources to fund space activities within the country, be it private or public. Also, ISRO was keen that the private sector should handle launching of satellites, a lucrative business, while ISRO could concentrate on specialised research programmes.

With the private sector moving into the area of space, there are a lot of issues which need to be tied up and for this purpose, the government has set up an organisation called the Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre (IN-SPACe).

There are a host of activities which need to be addressed by IN-SPACe.

The two major ones are: first, this organisation will have to ensure a level playing field between the public and the private sector. Second, IN-SPACe will also have a regulatory role and as far as the private sector is concerned, it has to



PRIVATISATION FLIP SIDE. The lack of skilled personnel will impact the operations of both private and public sectors

ensure that its activities are in harmony with all the international treaties on space where India is a signatory.

TALENT HUNT Meanwhile, it seems that over a hundred scientists have left ISRO last year possibly because the private sector is offering not only better salaries but also stock options. The fact that government jobs are bereft of meritocracy is also proving to be a disadvantage.

The government has decided to put restrictions on senior scientists leaving ISRO. This especially applies to scientists working in specialised space projects such as Gaganyaan and Chandrayaan. While the concern of the

The private sector has no option but to source its manpower from ISRO and its affiliates. Getting expatriates to work here was never really an option

government is well appreciated, it was only obvious that such a situation would eventually arise. The private sector has no option but to source its manpower from ISRO and its affiliates. Getting expatriates to work here at much higher salaries was never really an option. If availability of manpower becomes a critical issue for the private sector, it is going to choke its growth and the vision of the government to engage ISRO only in research activities may falter.

NUCLEAR ISSUES A similar manpower crunch is also likely to occur in nuclear generation. Now that the private sector has the option of moving into nuclear generation aided by the Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India (SHANTI) Act, there is going to be a clamour for manpower with the requisite skills. Already a number of leading industrial groups are proceeding full steam for nuclear generation.

One of them is evaluating sites across several States to deploy large modular

reactors and is in talks with global leaders for collaboration. Another major industrial house plans a 6000-MW nuclear plant in Ratnagiri, Maharashtra.

Yet another industrial house has committed \$2 trillion to develop a 7.2 GW nuclear power capacity. Needless to say, the private sector will depend upon organisations like the Nuclear Power Corporation of India (NPCIL) and the Bharatiya Nabhikiya Vidyut Nigam Limited (BHAVINI) for sourcing their manpower needs.

The government will soon have to prepare a contingency plan to deal with this issue. Drain of manpower from the public sector was also experienced when private banking and insurance companies mushroomed in India.

Manpower requirements along with other inputs have to be assessed prior to privatisation. We owe it to the private sector to keep them informed of the difficulties that they may face in getting indigenous manpower.

The writer is visiting professor, ICRIER and former Member (Economic & Commercial), CEA

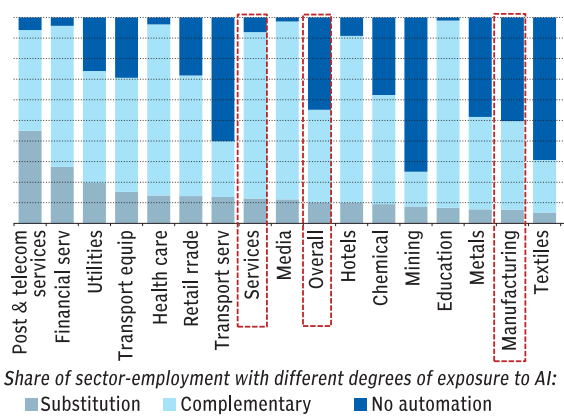
STATISTALK.

Compiled Dhuraveil Gunasekaran | Graphic Visveswaran V

AI won't steal India's jobs. It'll reshape them

Generative AI is set to transform India's economy by boosting productivity more than displacing jobs, according to a Goldman Sachs report. The report estimates that AI will complement 42-48% of India's non-agricultural workforce, while only 8-12% of jobs face substitution risk, pointing to augmentation rather than widespread job losses. In its baseline scenario, Gen-AI could lift India's annual labour productivity growth by 0.4 percentage points, with the potential gains ranging from 0.1 to 0.8 percentage points. AI exposure is highest in knowledge-intensive services such as healthcare, education and financial services, while construction, mining and manufacturing remain relatively insulated due to their reliance on physical work.

AI is more likely to assist than replace India's workforce

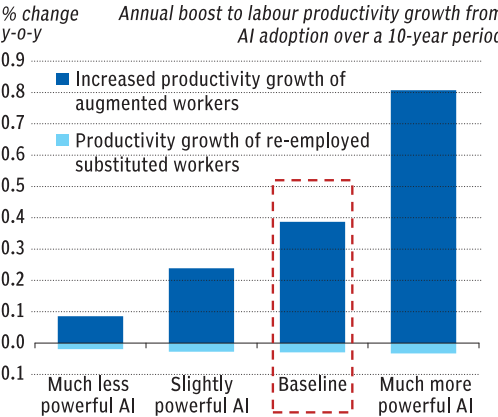


Where AI could deliver the biggest productivity boost

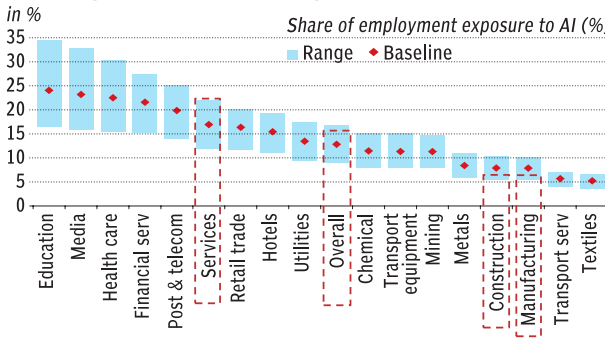


Source: Goldman Sachs

AI could meaningfully lift India's productivity



Knowledge industries stand to gain the most



thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

August 5, 2006

Chidambaram defends advisory to banks on PLR

The Finance Minister, Mr P Chidambaram, on Friday justified the move to 'advise' public sector banks to consult their boards before revising lending rates, stating that the Government as a majority shareholder had a right to express its views on such decisions.

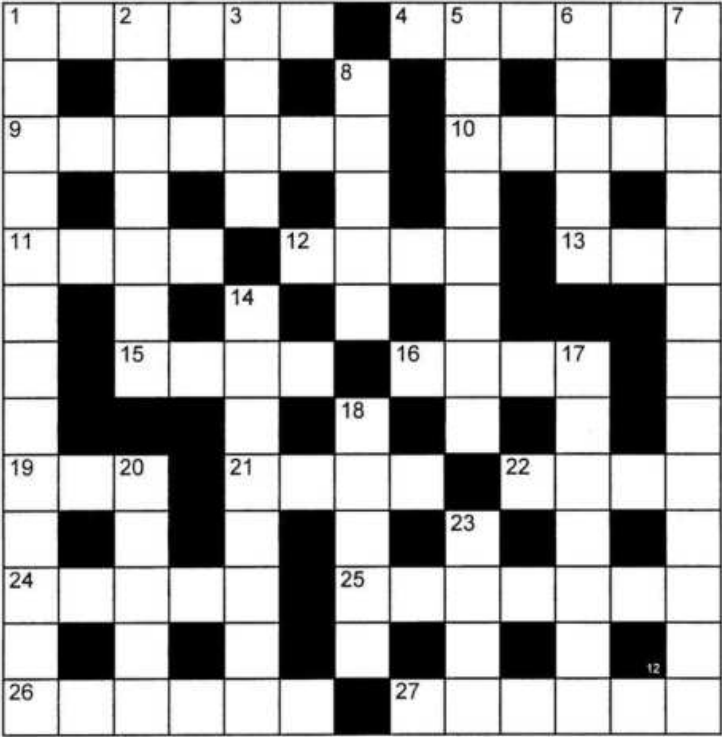
PSU bankers 'surprised'

The Finance Ministry's letter to some public sector banks asking them to get their board approval for the recent rate hikes has surprised many bankers here. A senior bank official said the recent increase in interest rates by banks actually followed the RBI's hike in its key short-term rates. Banks have to match their lending rates with their cost of funds.

Iran gas pipeline: Consultant to decide on pricing

With no solution to the impasse on the gas pricing issue for the \$7-billion Iran-Pakistan-India pipeline project, the three nations today decided to appoint an international consultant for the purpose. A decision to this effect was taken after two-day Secretarial level trilateral talks failed to create a breakthrough on the issue.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2707



EASY

ACROSS

01. Overrun foreign territory (6)
04. Plant supplying saffron (6)
09. 'Funny' drawing (7)
10. Porter's room (5)
11. Coloured part of eye (4)
12. Vocalise (4)
13. A slender stick (3)
15. Gas used for advertising signs (4)
16. Halt (4)
19. Part of circumference (3)
21. Weathercock (4)
22. A zone (4)
24. Room with window built out (5)
25. Play into each other's hands (7)
26. Cried out loudly (6)
27. A loving gesture (6)

DOWN

01. Implicating one in a charge (13)
02. A translation, particular form (7)
03. Let fall (4)
05. Remove to a lower class (8)
06. Drink of fermented apple juice (5)
07. Resolution, unswayable quality (13)
08. Gasteropod (5)
14. Affect with spasms, violently agitate (8)
17. Take it for granted (7)
18. Light meal (5)
20. To make cold (5)
23. Parasitic insect (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

01. And, I've found a way to enter by force (6)
04. In short, a reptile gets us to come into flower (6)
09. A preliminary drawing of a vehicle to take on (7)
10. Temporarily put up with a teepee? (5)
11. One will almost get up with the flag (4)
12. To be an informer, one will be vocal (4)
13. Five-and-a-half yards of drain to clear out? (3)
15. Name one adopts for lighting: it's a gas (4)
16. Don't go on with the aperture setting (4)
19. Sort of welding used in familiar construction-work (3)
21. Commercial vehicle going east to show which way the wind blows (4)
22. Make haste and find the waistband (4)
24. Does it give one a window on the Loire? (5)
25. Fraudulently conspire with Colonel to arrange duel (7)
26. Half cowardly, went ahead and cried out (6)
27. Gesture of love that scares, in a way (6)

DOWN

01. Involving one in crime at home, maybe I'm in car with Tory (13)
02. Get over sin in one way of telling the story (7)
03. Doctor having small operation will not go on with it (4)
05. Engineers get an ambassador to send one down a division (8)
06. In the Diplomatic Corps one will sound hesitant as to drink (5)
07. Determination with which dates are broken quickly at the Loch (13)
08. One makes slow progress at its pace (5)
14. Double one up with five clues no different from this (8)
17. Take it one will quietly start giving (7)
18. Tins returned by end of week giving one a bite to eat (5)
20. Sort of cold that's caught on an upland (5)
23. It bites its host a trifle awkwardly to some degree (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2706

ACROSS 1. Diplomat 4. Irate 8. Sirlain 9. Offered 10. Sale 12. Sidecar 14. Salvage 17. Wear 18. Convert 21. Overlay 22. Lover 23. Abnegate

DOWN 1. Disuse 2. Parallel 3. Oboe 4. Annoys 5. Pair 6. Sender 7. Infidel 11. Amateur 13. Camellia 14. Sickle 15. Entomb 16. Groyne 19. Nave 20. Peke

QUICKLY.

Fermenta Biotech shares make debut on NSE



Mumbai: Fermenta Biotech Ltd, one of the world's largest manufacturers of the active pharmaceutical ingredient in Vitamin D3, has listed its shares on the NSE. The listing marks a milestone in Fermenta's 75-year journey, it said. The company said its shares would remain listed on the BSE. Fermenta's NSE listing reflects its growth, expanding global customer base and widening investor interest, it said. Prashant Nagre, MD, Fermenta, said, "Fermenta's listing on the NSE represents a significant milestone in a landmark year for the company, as we commemorate 75 years of Fermenta and nearly five decades as a publicly listed enterprise... We will continue to enhance our capabilities across nutrition, food fortification, green chemistry and specialised solutions." OUR BUREAU

Greaves Electric raises ₹530 crore via rights issue

Mumbai: Greaves Electric Mobility Ltd (GEML) on Tuesday said it has raised ₹530 crore through a rights issue to strengthen the company's next phase of growth. The investment will firm up GEML's electric two- and three-wheeler portfolio, deepen technology development and support execution in a competitive, fast-adopting EV market, the company said. The investment is fully subscribed by the existing shareholders in proportion to their existing shareholding, including Greaves Cotton Ltd and Abdul Latif Jameel Green Mobility Solutions. PFI

LIC offer for sale gets bids worth ₹36,400 crore from institutions

ON THE CARDS. A discount of ₹10/share will be given to retail investors, employees

Press Trust of India New Delhi

Institutional investors on Tuesday over-subscribed the government's 6.5 per cent share sale offer in the Life Insurance Corporation of India by putting in bids worth ₹36,400 crore. Four years after the initial public offering, which fetched ₹21,000 crore, the government has launched LIC's offer for sale (OFS), whose size compares with the upcoming mega IPO offerings of the NSE and Reliance Jio Platforms. Through the two-day OFS window, the government is selling over 82.22 crore shares (including green-shoe option) in LIC at a floor price of ₹382/share. The issue

Aggressive bidding

	No. of shares	% of total*
Total	94,45,44,898	331.86
100% margin	10,85,14,572	38.13
0% margin	83,60,30,326	293.73

Note: Base issue: 31,62,49,885
Greenshoe option 50,59,99,816
*Over base issue

comprises a base offer size of 2.5 per cent, with a green shoe option of 4 per cent. The issue will open for retail investors on Wednesday. "A discount of ₹10 per equity share will be given only to those retail investors and employees bidding at the cut-off price," LIC said. Institutional investors put in bids for over 94.45 crore shares at an indicative price



of ₹383.84/share. The bids are valued at ₹36,400 crore at the indicative price bid. Shares of LIC slid 7.86 per cent to close at ₹391 on the BSE. The floor price of ₹382/share was set at a 10 per cent discount over Monday's closing price of ₹424.35 on the BSE. At the floor price, the OFS will fetch about ₹31,000

crore to the government. In a post on X, Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) Secretary Arunish Chawla said, "This enthusiastic participation reflects robust investor confidence and the depth of India's capital markets."

PUBLIC HOLDING NORM The stake sale will help LIC achieve the minimum public shareholding requirement mandated by market regulator SEBI ahead of schedule. SEBI had given the LIC time till May 16, 2027, to achieve a minimum 10 per cent public shareholding. At present, the government holds a 96.5 per cent stake in LIC. It earlier sold 3.5 per cent through an initial public offering in May 2022.

Ather Energy vrooms to a new high

Our Bureau Bengaluru

Ather Energy shares settled 14 per cent higher after hitting an all-time high on Tuesday after the company reported a sharp narrowing in its quarterly loss.

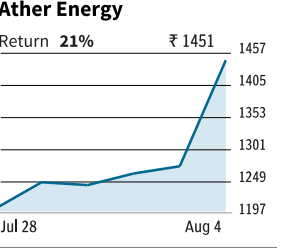
The stock closed 14 per cent higher at ₹1,450.40 on the NSE, after hitting a fresh weekly high of ₹1,500.

The stock had closed at ₹1,272.70 in the previous session.

The company reported a sharp improvement in its financial performance, with consolidated net loss narrowing to ₹51.1 crore in Q1FY27.

EV DEMAND

According to the management, EV demand remains very strong, supported by government policy and the positive total cost of ownership for electric vehicles. The company said Delhi's EV policy should largely continue with some changes



due to strong consumer support, while other States are also showing greater support for EV adoption. It also said Ather is receiving 2,36,000 enquiries and 50,000 bookings every month.

Global brokerage CLSA maintained an 'Outperform' rating on Ather Energy with a target price of ₹1,600. The brokerage said volumes jumped 81 per cent y-o-y in Q1FY27, ahead of the electric two-wheeler industry's 68 per cent y-o-y growth, while EBITDA margin improved 319 basis points q-o-q to negative 2.7 per cent despite commodity headwinds.

According to CLSA, bookings are tracking around 50,000 units per month against capacity of 35,000 units per month, making the company capacity-constrained rather than demand-constrained. The brokerage also expects the EL platform launch during the festive period to sustain volume momentum.

HSBC retained its buy rating and raised its target price to ₹1,450.

The brokerage said margin performance was driven by a surprisingly sharp reduction in other expenses.

Nomura maintained its buy rating with a target price of ₹1,714. The brokerage said the EV inflection is now in the fast lane and retained Ather as its top two-wheeler pick.

It highlighted that the Q1FY27 EBITDA margin of negative 2.7 per cent was ahead of its estimate of negative 5.6 per cent and identified the EL platform launch and the new plant as the next key catalysts.

BSE net profit up 62 per cent in Q1

Our Bureau Mumbai

BSE, the country's oldest stock exchange, reported that its net profit in the June quarter was up 62 per cent at ₹873 crore against ₹538 crore logged in the same period last year. Revenue increased 63 per cent to ₹1,566 crore (₹958 crore).

TO HIKE STAKE IN IIBH The exchange intends to increase its stake in India International Bullion Holding IFSC by secondary purchase from its subsidiaries India International Exchange and India International Clearing Corporation. BSE will acquire 50 crore



shares with an investment of ₹50.50 crore from its subsidiaries. BSE intends to consolidate the shareholding in IIBH directly in BSE, instead of such shareholding being held by its subsidiaries. Upon the completion of the present acquisition, BSE's direct shareholding in IIBH will increase from 3.33 per cent to 20 per cent, and

IIBH will consequently become a direct associate company of the BSE, it said.

The overall transaction charges collected by the exchange increased to ₹1,328 crore (₹737 crore) while income from listing services was down marginally at ₹100 crore (105 crore).

The average daily turnover on the exchange was up at ₹9,955 crore (₹7,180 crore) with transaction charges of ₹65 crore (₹55 crore).

The average daily premium turnover was higher at ₹29,615 crore (₹15,084 crore). Revenue increased to ₹1,155 crore (₹598 crore). BSE Star MF revenue was up 20 per cent at ₹73 crore (₹61 crore).

Anupama Ghosh Mumbai

Electric vehicles are not cannibalising internal combustion engine sales in India's two-wheeler market. EV became a plus one at home, according to Rahul Dhoot, founder and Managing Director of Dhoot Transmission Ltd. He made the point at the company's IPO press conference on Tuesday. "EV is growing and ICE is also growing," he said.

The company's IPO opens on August 10 and closes on August 12, with a price band of ₹829-871 a share.

The total issue size is ₹3,067 crore, comprising a fresh issue of ₹1,400 crore

and an offer for sale of approximately 1.91 crore shares by promoters BC Asia Investments XV Ltd, an entity of private equity firm Bain Capital, and Mangalam Capital Private Ltd.

FUND UTILISATION Of the fresh proceeds, ₹766 crore will retire existing debt, ₹150 crore will fund two new manufacturing facilities, and the rest is earmarked for general corporate purposes and unspecified acquisitions.

Post-IPO, the company expects to carry a cash surplus of roughly ₹900-₹1,000 crore on a debt-free balance sheet. The anchor investor date is August 7.

That assessment under-



Rahul Dhoot, MD, Dhoot Transmission

pins the Aurangabad-headquartered company's growth thesis. India's two-wheeler production stood at roughly 21 million units in both 2019 and 2026, yet Dhoot's revenues grew five-fold, from ₹900 crore to ₹4,500 crore over the same period.

Chief Financial Officer Nitinkumar Kalani attrib-

uted the divergence to a sharp rise in content per vehicle, particularly as emission norms shifted from BS4 to BS6 and EV adoption climbed. Kalani put numbers to the shift — a BS4 vehicle that previously represented ₹100 of content for the company now represents ₹400 at the BS6 stage; an equivalent EV represents ₹2,000.

"If it is 10 EVs increasing for us, it is as good as 50 ICE increasing for us," he said.

The company supplies charging cords, off-board chargers, high-voltage and low-voltage wiring harnesses, battery assemblies, DC-DC converters, motor harnesses and USB-C chargers across the EV powertrain.

‘Our ambition is to become a multi-segment exchange’

bl.interview

Suresh P Iyengar Mumbai



We believe India should strengthen its presence in neighbouring capital markets, wherever such opportunities arise

ARUN RASTE MD & CEO, NCDEX

mean it literally.

How did AMCs respond to your idea?

They were extremely supportive because they had never been able to build a meaningful rural distribution network. They viewed this as a completely new opportunity and provided training material and support for our certification programmes.

We want to work with only top-20 AMCs and start with already known brands such as SBI, LIC and HDFC. Anyway, the top 20 AMCs account for about 80 per cent of industry assets.

Why MF distribution before the NCDEX's equity venture?

MF distribution was not part of our original business plan when we approached investors. Therefore, this initiative has created additional value and generated positive investor interest.

On equity trading, User Acceptance Testing has begun and system integration is complete. We expect to be ready for SEBI inspection by November. Subject to regulatory approvals, we intend to launch the cash equity segment in January. About six months after equities stabilise, we plan to introduce equity derivatives.

Nearly two crore new investors enter India's capital markets every year. Rather

than competing with larger exchanges, my focus is on new investor base. Roughly 40 per cent of these new investors come from smaller towns, which is exactly the market where our brand already has strong recognition.

How are you addressing the mis-selling risk?

Mis-selling generally happens with complex or exotic products. Farmers typically receive two kinds of income — large seasonal payments after harvest and regular income from activities such as dairy or poultry.

Our focus is on two simple products: lump-sum investments after harvest and SIPs of ₹1,000-2,000 funded through regular income. Since FPOs belong to the same community as their investors, there is strong peer accountability.

Does venturing into equities and MFs mean that commodities will take a back seat?

Absolutely not. Commodities remain our core business. Our ambition is to become a multi-segment exchange. The larger exchanges started with equities and later expanded into commodities. We are following the opposite path — building on our strength in commodities while expanding into mutual funds and equities in a differentiated manner.

The NCDEX has also announced international partnerships. What is the strategy?

We have signed an MoU to help establish a commodities exchange in Sri Lanka, subject to approvals from the Sri Lankan regulator.

We have also signed an MoU with the Chittagong Stock Exchange. Subject to approval from the government, we may acquire a stake in the exchange.

This is strategically important because Bangladesh has two stock exchanges, and the Shanghai Stock Exchange already owns a stake in the Dhaka Stock Exchange.

We believe India should strengthen its presence in neighbouring capital markets, wherever such opportunities arise.

BROKER'S CALL.

Geojit Financial

TVS MOTOR (BUY)

Target: ₹4,780
CMP: ₹4,360
TVS Motor (TVS) is one of the largest two-wheeler manufacturers in India, with a domestic market share of about 19.6 per cent in FY26. Q1FY27 revenue rose 38 per cent year-on-year to ₹13,896 crore led by 28 per cent volume growth. EBITDA grew 41 per cent to ₹1,779 crore and PAT rose 51 per cent to ₹1,174 crore, including a fair valuation gain of ₹150 crore against ₹28 crore last year. Gross margin contracted about 160 bps to 27.2 per cent as commodity inflation outpaced the price hike and richer product mix. EBITDA margin still rose 28 bps to 12.8 per cent, supported by operating leverage and cost optimisation. EV 2W sales jumped 86 per cent to 1.30 lakh units with revenue of about ₹1,780 crore. Exports hit a record 4.68 lakh units, up 33 per cent, with international business revenue of ₹3,634 crore. Three-wheeler sales grew 48 per cent to 66,697 units. The demand outlook remains healthy, supported by GST rationalisation, income-tax relief and improving affordability, though monsoon progression and inflation need watching. The management expects Q2 momentum to match or slightly exceed Q1 across domestic and export markets. Calibrated pricing, product and geography mix, scale and cost reduction should support the EBITDA journey. We value TVS' standalone business at 37x FY28E EPS (₹4,525/share) and TVS Credit Services at ₹255 (2x P/BV with 15 per cent holding dis.) to arrive at a target price of ₹4,780 and maintain Buy rating.

Emkay Global

ADITYA BIRLA LIFESTYLE (BUY)

Target: ₹140
CMP: ₹94.53
We maintain Buy on Aditya Birla Lifestyle Brands (ABLB) and TP of ₹140 (20x June 2028E EBITDA). While Q1 revenue was in line, EBITDA was 7 per cent/6 per cent ahead of our/street expectations, led by better performance in emerging segments. ABLB sustained its double-digit growth momentum, at about 11 per cent in Q1. Growth was led by the online channel, while the wholesale channel grew slower, as primary sales were temporarily hit due to the change in the festive calendar; secondary sales growth was healthy, in double digits. Small towns continue to be a key growth engine for the company, delivering double-digit growth for the fifth consecutive quarter. . ABLB attributed the sustained momentum to strong execution, an improved merchandise mix, and a gradual recovery in demand. While Peter England remains the dominant brand in these markets, Allen Solly, Van Heusen and Louis Philippe have also expanded their presence. Looking ahead, the management believes the contribution of small towns to retail sales, currently at 15-16 per cent, has the potential to exceed 20 per cent over the next three-five years.

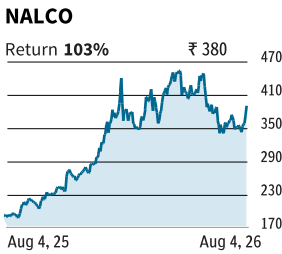
It remains watchful of inflation in key raw materials and a potential demand slowdown due to the rise in inflation in H2, though there is no major visible impact as of now. We remain positive on ABLB, driven by low double-digit topline growth prospects and gradual margin gains, with turnaround in emerging businesses.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Nalco (₹380.50): BUY

Gurumurthy K bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook is bullish for National Aluminium Company Ltd (Nalco). The 4.5 per cent rise on Tuesday confirms a double bottom pattern on the daily chart. This is a bullish pattern. It has formed above the 200-Day Moving Average. That, in turn, strengthens the bullish case. The neckline support of this pattern is coming around ₹368, which could limit the downside. Moving average indicators are also showing bullish signals.

The Nalco share price can rise to ₹400 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Nalco now at ₹381. Accumulate on

dips at ₹373. Keep the stop-loss at ₹364. Trail the stop-loss higher to ₹385 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹389. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹388 and ₹393 when the price touches ₹392 and ₹397 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹400.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24553 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24500	24460	24580	24620	Go long only above 24580. Stop-loss can be placed at 24560	

₹739 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
737	732	742	746	Go short only below 737. Stop-loss can be kept at 739	

₹1158 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1150	1130	1170	1200	Take fresh shorts below 1150. Keep the stop-loss at 1155	

₹286 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
284	282	289	293	Go long only above 289. Stop-loss can be placed at 288	

₹242 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
239	236	243	246	Outlook is unclear. Avoid trading this stock for now	

₹1293 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1285	1265	1300	1320	Go short on a break below 1285 with a stop-loss at 1290	

₹1035 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1020	1000	1045	1065	Go long on a bounce from 1020. Keep the stop-loss at 1015	

₹2444 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2420	2385	2480	2500	Go long on a bounce from 2420. Stop-loss can be kept at 2410	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 159.40 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Hindalco	1020.00	7.94	17.12	1.31	
Apollo Hosp	9050.00	5.17	64.98	0.83	
ITC	289.00	4.21	17.94	2.47	
Trent Ltd.	3107.70	4.20	96.27	0.92	
Eternal Ltd.	312.40	3.00	696.25	0.01	
JSW Steel	1300.00	1.58	11.36	2.08	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	265.00	1.43	84.68	0.77	
Bajaj Finserv	2100.00	1.14	16.33	1.08	
Adani Ports	1706.70	0.92	29.97	1.12	
M&M	3433.00	0.86	21.09	2.72	
Coal India	417.60	0.84	8.28	0.89	
Kotak Bank	398.00	0.80	19.50	2.60	
Maruti Suzuki	14168.00	0.51	31.08	1.64	
Sun Pharma	1964.00	0.12	38.89	1.85	
ONGC	242.00	0.00	6.11	0.83	
Tech Mahindra	1648.50	-0.07	31.29	0.93	
Tata Steel	190.95	-0.09	21.16	1.40	
UltraTech Cement	1205.00	-0.10	41.43	1.27	
Bharti Airtel	1970.10	-0.27	35.49	5.33	
Tata Motors PV	348.55	-0.34	4278.84	0.62	
Bharat Elec	391.50	-0.51	46.55	1.24	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1087.30	-0.89	22.60	1.35	
Ox Reddys Lab	1172.50	-0.99	30.75	0.63	
Adani Enter	3050.00	-1.14	52.81	0.78	
Wipro	186.30	-1.40	13.89	0.45	
NestleIndia	1520.00	-1.57	76.91	0.97	
SBI Life	1899.00	-1.57	73.24	0.76	
HCL Tech	1369.90	-1.64	21.32	1.28	
Cipla	1466.00	-1.77	35.15	0.73	
Integrosph	5358.00	-2.08	0.00	1.08	
State Bank	1042.70	-2.08	11.11	3.83	
Bajaj Finance	1149.00	-2.34	34.65	2.73	
TataConsumerProduct	1092.00	-2.56	65.81	0.63	
TCS	2460.00	-3.06	17.78	2.23	
Asian Paints	2775.00	-3.46	55.03	1.11	
Eicher Motors	7989.00	-3.49	37.73	0.97	
PowerGrid Corp	283.40	-3.56	16.55	1.14	
Max Healthcare	1077.00	-3.81	72.67	0.71	
HDFC Life	535.95	-4.03	58.55	0.51	
Titan	4935.00	-5.86	86.35	1.81	
Bajaj Auto	11600.00	-6.20	28.06	1.14	
Abs Bank	1261.80	-6.40	14.05	3.22	
NTPC	243.65	-7.51	11.76	1.45	
Hind Unilever	2096.50	-8.05	46.94	1.65	
ICI Bank	1454.60	-8.45	17.46	9.25	
L&T	3990.00	-8.95	27.97	4.15	
Infosys	1167.50	-9.58	15.62	3.64	
Grasim Ind	3138.00	-10.06	20.73	1.05	
HDFC Bank	742.00	-10.31	52.01	1.63	
Reliance Ind	1290.90	-41.48	19.81	7.74	

CM
Y
K

QUICKLY.

Apple seeks block in trade secrets case

Bengaluru: Apple on Monday asked a US judge for a preliminary injunction barring two former employees and OpenAI from accessing, acquiring, using or disclosing alleged confidential information as it moves ahead with its trade secrets case. Apple last month sued OpenAI and the two former employees, both now working for OpenAI, alleging misappropriation of its trade secrets to benefit ChatGPT. **REUTERS**

US trade deficit contracts 5.6 per cent in June

Washington: The US trade deficit narrowed in June, but the trend is unlikely to be sustained amid strong domestic demand that is being satiated with imports. The trade shortfall contracted 5.6 per cent to \$73.3 billion, the Commerce Department's Bureau of Economic Analysis and Census Bureau said. **REUTERS**

'US plans ban on Chinese data centre devices on security fears'

CURBING INCURSION. Move aims to prevent Chinese firms from stealing data

Reuters
Washington

The Trump administration is drafting a ban on US imports of new models of Chinese data centre components, four people familiar with the matter told *Reuters*, as it seeks to protect the infrastructure that undergirds the AI boom.

The Federal Communications Commission, which oversees the US telecom industry, is working on the measure to bar imports of new Chinese optical transceivers, which allow data to travel over fibre-optic cables at the speed of light within data centres.

DECISION PENDING Officials hope to publish it this year, when it would take effect. The move, not previously reported, aims to prevent Chinese firms from stealing



DIPLOMATIC APPEAL. The Chinese embassy in Washington said Beijing urges the US to “heed the objective and rational voices of the business communities in both countries”

data, installing malware or disrupting service at US data centres, which house the chips to train and run AI models. The FCC could still modify or shelve the restriction, the sources stressed, speaking on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive matters. But it is the latest example of the ‘Trump administration trying to limit Chinese technological incursions into cutting-edge US industries before they be-

come embedded in the supply chain. “Transceivers definitely pose a risk,” said Divyansh Kaushik, an AI policy expert at Washington DC, advisory firm Beacon Global Strategies. “As the data centre build out scales up, you want to make sure their supply chain is secure from the get-go,” he added.

RESPOND IF NECESSARY The White House and the FCC did not respond to re-

quests for comment. The Chinese embassy in Washington said Beijing urges the US to “heed the objective and rational voices of the business communities in both countries” and “stop smearing Chinese companies and threatening them with sanctions.”

China hawks in the administration are keen to avoid another situation like Huawei, where telecom equipment made by the heavily sanctioned Chinese firm was so deeply embedded in US infrastructure that efforts to remove it were slow, expensive and incomplete.

A US ban on new models of Chinese data centre devices would likely hit China's Zhongji Innolight, one of the biggest global sellers of transceivers, which was added to the Pentagon's list of alleged Chinese military-backed companies in June. The list can be a harbinger of tougher action.

Citing SC ruling, 25 States in US sue Trump administration over latest tariffs

Press Trust of India
Washington

Twenty-five US states on Monday sued the Trump administration over its latest tariffs, alleging they were an attempt to replace import taxes that the Supreme Court struck down in February.

The US last month imposed double-digit tariffs on imports from 59 countries and the European Union, arguing that they had failed to do enough to curb imports made with forced labour.

The new duties took effect as temporary tariffs imposed by President Donald Trump following the Supreme Court ruling expired.

“After losing at the Supreme Court, the administration is once again trying to illegally raise taxes on families and businesses with a new round of tariffs,” New York Attorney General Letitia James said.

Trump, who argues that high tariffs will revive American manufacturing, last year

The US last month imposed double-digit tariffs on imports from 59 countries and the EU, saying they had failed to curb goods made with forced labour

reversed decades of US policy favouring lower tariffs and freer trade. Invoking the 1977 International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA), he imposed sweeping tariffs on imports from almost every country, citing the long-running US trade deficit as a national emergency. However, the Supreme Court ruled that the IEEPA did not authorise the imposition of tariffs, forcing the administration to refund duties collected from importers.

SHIFT TO SECTION 301 To offset the revenue loss, Trump introduced tempor-

ary 10 per cent global tariffs, which expired on July 24.

The administration has now turned to Section 301 of the Trade Act of 1974, which allows the President to impose tariffs and other sanctions against countries found to engage in unfair trade practices.

Trump had successfully used the provision during his first term to levy tariffs on China, and those measures withstood legal challenges.

Invoking Section 301, the administration imposed the new forced-labour tariffs of 10-12.5 per cent on countries accounting for 99 per cent of US imports.

White House spokesman Kush Desai said, “A foreign country's failure to prohibit and effectively enforce a ban on imports produced with forced labour is unreasonable and burdens US commerce, including American workers, and must be addressed. Section 301 tariffs have proven to be a legally durable tool since the President's first term, and they remain so now.”

India engaged with all stakeholders on Chabahar port operations, says MEA

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India is in touch with all stakeholders and partners regarding operations at Iran's strategically important Chabahar Port, even as the prolonged West Asia crisis and the expiry of the US sanctions waiver for the project have heightened uncertainty over its future.

Responding to a question on Chabahar during the weekly media briefing, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: “On Chabahar



MEA spokesperson
Randhir Jaiswal

operations, India is in contact with all stakeholders and associates regarding the matter.”

India's Chabahar project is strategically important as

it provides access to Afghanistan and Central Asia, while bypassing Pakistan. India Ports Global Ltd., a government-owned company, operates the Shahid Beheshti terminal under a long-term agreement with Iran.

KEY HUB

The project is also a key component of India's connectivity strategy through the International North-South Transport Corridor, aimed at improving trade links with Central Asia, Russia and Europe. The US had earlier

exempted Chabahar from certain sanctions on Iran, recognising its role in supporting Afghanistan's economic development.

However, the waiver expired in April this year, effectively bringing fresh Indian project activity at the port to a halt pending further clarity.

Some officials had earlier expressed hopes that US economic sanctions on port activities could be rolled back once a lasting peace deal was reached between the US and Iran.

Crude oil slips below \$80 on hopes of US-Iran deal

Bloomberg

Crude oil slid as optimism grew that the US and Iran are moving closer to a deal to reopen the vital Strait of Hormuz chokepoint.

Brent dropped more than 4 per cent below \$80 a barrel, reversing earlier gains. US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said in an interview with CNBC that “there is a chance we may have a deal today or tomorrow to open the Strait.”

Qatar, meanwhile, said a proposed de-escalation resolution was “being circulated between the parties.”

Both Qatar and Bessent cautioned there's no solid agreement yet and Iran has not signalled there's been progress on Hormuz.

LOOSE ENDS

Visible flows through the waterway, which carried about a fifth of the world's crude before the war, have slowed as attacks on vessels and Iranian threats heightened safety concerns for shipowners and crews.

Oil prices have eased dramatically from last month's peak, however, as President Donald Trump postponed new strikes on Iran to give talks more time.

The latest comments from Qatar on potential draft language for a deal appear to be part of a joint push to reopen Hormuz, while leaving the “even more difficult topics for later talks,” said Helge Andre Martinsen, Senior Oil Analyst at DNB Bank ASA.

Meanwhile, oil giant Saudi Aramco said it is looking at options to expand its crude export capacity, including by potentially increasing the size of an east-west pipeline to the port of Yanbu, a Hormuz bypass that's become a vital lifeline for Saudi Arabia during the war. The kingdom's observed crude exports edged lower in July as

the war disrupted flows through Hormuz and Houthi rebels threatened shipments in the Red Sea.

As conflict impedes flows from the region, global oil markets are “absolutely” in a supply deficit, Pacific Investment Management Co's Greg Sharenow said in an interview with *Bloomberg* television on Tuesday.

Meanwhile, Ukraine's shifting strikes across Russia's oil supply chain increase the risk of further disruptions.

Large refineries, oil tankers, and major pipeline infrastructure were hit at least 30 times in July.

Hatsun Agro Product plans ₹1,000 crore capex in FY27 to enhance production

Rohan Das
Chennai

Hatsun Agro Product (HAP), India's largest private sector dairy company has planned investments of around ₹1,000 crore in FY27.

In an interview, RG Chandramogan, Chairman, Hatsun Agro Product, suggested that the proceeds will be allocated towards expanding the company's milk procurement and distribution network while also revamping some of its production facilities and marketing efforts.

He added that the investments are part of Hatsun Agro's plan to sell roughly 2.4 crore product packs per day within the next two years, up from the current 1.84 crore packs.

The Chennai-based firm posted revenues of ₹9,959 crore in FY26 — an increase of 14.5 per cent from the previous fiscal.

Chandramogan suggested that despite a challenging environment for the dairy industry, the company had achieved strong growth in Q1FY27. “We are already at 19 per cent growth. If we can sustain it we will be close to ₹12,000 crore in FY27,” he said.

On the margin front, he added that while rising input costs have compressed margins across the industry, Hatsun has been able to post better margins due to the difference in business models.

NO MIDDLEMEN

“We don't have any middlemen either on the procurement side or the distribution side. We operate from our own outlets or franchisee outlets so there are no other layers. This along with our strongest branding as the market leader across categories are the reasons our margins are better,” he ad-



RG Chandramogan, Chairman,
Hatsun Agro Product **BIJAY GHOSH**

ded. The company has seen a 13 per cent year-on-year increase in milk procurement prices with Chandramogan attributing weather-related pressures, rising cattle feed costs and higher milk fat prices for the inflation.

“We delayed price hikes instead of immediately passing on higher procurement costs. We preferred waiting for the costs to sta-

bile rather than implementing multiple successive price increases,” he said.

NEW PRODUCTS

Hatsun also plans to launch its range of protein-rich drinks within the next 1-2 months.

The founder added that detailed product information will be announced closer to launch, and did not disclose pricing or product specifications. Apart from protein beverages, Hatsun is also working on new ice-cream variants and chocolate products.

Hatsun Agro currently operates around 4,100 HAP Daily outlets as localised micro-distribution networks for its dairy products sold under major brands including Arokya, Arun and Hatsun alongside 220 Ibaco outlets, its premium ice-cream brand. It plans to scale its store presence to over 5,000 by the financial year-end.

Progress made toward US-Iran talks, says Qatar

Reuters

Dubai/Washington

Qatar said mediators were making progress in efforts to end the US-Iran war on Tuesday, although Tehran has denied President Donald Trump's assertion that talks are already under way.

Oil prices fell quickly after the comments from Qatar, extending Monday's steep losses on hopes that an arrangement could soon be reached to unfreeze traffic through the blockaded Strait of Hormuz. But for now, the Strait remained virtually shut, with another ship reportedly coming under attack while trying to cross it.

Trump said on Monday that talks with Tehran had started and Iran faced a “last chance” to reach a deal. Iranian officials insisted no negotiations with the US were taking place. Iran said its only talks are with Oman about the Strait, and that no major meetings were



planned this week. “They are going on right now,” Trump told reporters at an Oval Office event on Monday when asked about negotiations, adding that discussions were taking place at the request of Iran, Saudi Arabia, the UAE and Qatar. “This is a last chance for them (Iran) to sign a good document.”

Qatar's foreign ministry spokesperson Majed al-Ansari said diplomatic contacts had reached “very progressive stages.” Ansari said on Tuesday that mediators including Qatar, Pakistan and Oman were coordinating

closely to facilitate negotiations and exchange draft proposals between Washington and Tehran.

A senior Pakistani security official said: “A lot is happening in the background ... We are talking to both sides. Our sole goal at this moment is to make both parties at least agree to start talking.”

Trump's comments followed his weekend decision to cancel what he described as “massive attacks” on Iran, extending a pattern in which he has threatened major military action before later backing off and pointing to diplomatic contacts.

RISKS REMAIN

Iran has halted most traffic through Hormuz while Washington maintains a blockade of Iran-related shipping and ports, disrupting a corridor that normally carries about a fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas shipments.

A cargo vessel reported being struck by an unidenti-

fied projectile near the Strait of Hormuz off Oman's coast, according to the UKMT maritime security agency. Maritime sources told Reuters on Tuesday that the vessel was a dry bulk ship. Its crew had to abandon the vessel and one seafarer was missing.

Iran has long demanded control over the Strait, which it says it should share with Oman, which controls the opposite shore.

A senior Iranian source said Iran is seeking full control over inbound shipping through the Strait, and visibility over outbound traffic, with the ability to intervene if necessary.

Giving Iran such control would be a major shift in the regional balance of power in Tehran's favour, and make it more difficult for the US administration to argue that “Operation Epic Fury”, which Trump launched alongside Israel in February, had weakened Washington's longstanding foe.

Consider telecom manufacturing zone in M.P. extension of PLI, says Scindia

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

India's first telecom manufacturing zone (TMZ) will serve as an extension of the current production-linked incentive, said Union Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia during the Telecom Manufacturing Zone Investors Meet in Mumbai.

The TMZ to be set up in Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh, is to attract ₹10,000-12,000 crore investment over two phases, focusing on 5G and 6G hardware, semiconductors, and optical fiber. Apart from being the first TMZ in the country, Scindia clarified that this will be the only such zone by the government.

“You can think of this TMZ as an extension of the PLI. There is close to ₹12,000 crore worth of in-



Minister for Communications
Jyotiraditya Scindia

vestments in this TMZ. Investors will almost get ₹7,000-8,000 crore worth of incentives back. So in a way this is also a PLI,” said Scindia, when asked about sustaining PLI production volumes.

MAJOR PUSH

PLI had led to almost ₹6,500 crore worth of investments, ₹1,20,000 crore worth of rev-

enue, ₹25,600 crore worth of exports and the creation of 35,000 jobs, according to Scindia.

Representatives of 20 telecom stakeholders, including Jio, Airtel and Vi, participated in the closed door event.

“About 17 companies here, who have committed investments or committed to invest... they will be going to in the drawing board. Many companies that have invested are saying that 80 per cent of their production will be done,” said Scindia, citing representatives from various verticals OEMs, telcos, chip designers, bank investors, etc.

The commitments received will consider manufacturing, value addition and IP creation. Many companies spoke of wanting to set up their own testing labs and R&D labs.

ONGC consolidated net profit down at ₹6,554 cr

Our Bureau
New Delhi

State-run ONGC on Tuesday reported a 43 per cent decline in its consolidated net profit at around ₹6,554 crore during Q1 FY27 as the net loss of ₹12,265 crore by Hindustan Petroleum Corporation was partially off-set by higher crude oil price realisation.

On a sequential basis, the country's largest exploration and production (E&P) company's net profit fell by a steeper 52 per cent.

However, ONGC on a standalone basis reported a net profit of ₹17,034 crore, more than double on an annual basis.

Consolidated total income was higher at around ₹2.08 lakh crore in Q1 FY27 compared to ₹1.77 lakh crore

in Q4 FY26 and Rs ₹1.66 lakh crore in Q1 FY26. ONGC's consolidated total expenses were higher in the June quarter at roughly ₹2.02 lakh crore compared to ₹1.61 lakh crore in Q4 FY26 and ₹1.50 lakh crore in Q1 FY26.

“The ONGC Group's consolidated Profit After Tax (PAT) for the quarter was significantly impacted by HPCL's consolidated net loss of ₹12,265 crore, primarily on account of under-recoveries on petroleum products arising from the sharp increase in crude oil prices following the West Asia crisis,” ONGC said in a statement.

However, the strong performance of other subsidiaries, including ONGC Videsh and MRPL, provided a positive contribution to the group's overall financial performance, it added.

KRITIKA WIRES LIMITED				
Regd Office: 1A, Bonfield Lane, Mezanine Floor, Kolkata – 700001 CIN - L27102WB2004PLC098699, Phone No. (033) 40037817 Website: www.kritikawires.com, Email: compliance@kritikawires.com				
EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE, 2026 (Rs. In lakhs except per share data)				
Particulars	QUARTER ENDED			Year Ended
	30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026
	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1. Total Income from operations	16321.16	14744.02	20771.92	69795.90
2. Net Profit for the period/year (before Tax and Exceptional item)	143.49	175.86	185.16	921.45
3. Net Profit for the period/year before Tax (after Exceptional item)	143.49	175.86	185.16	733.90
4. Net Profit for the period/year after Tax (after Exceptional item)	159.98	205.16	137.61	619.42
5. Total Comprehensive Income for the period/year (Comprising Profit and other Comprehensive Income)	166.15	233.21	135.92	641.88
6. Equity Share Capital [Face value of Rs. 2/- each]	5,325.60	5,325.60	5,325.60	5,325.60
7. Other Equity excluding Revaluation Reserve				4,756.68
8. Earning per Share				
(i) Basic (Rs.)	0.06	0.08	0.05	0.23
(ii) Diluted (Rs.)	0.06	0.08	0.05	0.23
NOTES: 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of unaudited Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. 2. The full format of the unaudited Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange website i.e. NSE website (www.nseindia.com) and Company's website (www.kritikawires.com).				
Registered Office : 1A, Bonfield Lane, Mezanine Floor, Kolkata - 700001 Phone No. (033) 2242 9581/ 2213 0660 Website : www.kritikawires.com				
Place of Signature : Kolkata Date: 04.08.2026			For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of Kritika Wires Limited Sd/- Managing Director	

QUICKLY.

Copper hits 2-month high as inventories dip



Copper vaulted above the \$14,000 mark to a two-month peak on Tuesday, driven higher by dwindling inventories outside the US and hopes for a resolution of the Iran war, even as the status of negotiations was unclear. Benchmark three month copper on the LME jumped 1.3 per cent to \$14,053 a tonne, its highest since June 2, after the release of LME stocks data. REUTERS

Gold rises as traders eye Fed rate outlook

Gold prices gained, supported by a decline in oil prices that tempered inflation fears and lowered US interest rate hike bets, while the markets awaited further clues on the Fed's policy path. Spot gold rose 0.6 per cent to \$4,078.10 per ounce by 1329 GMT. US gold futures gained 1.1 per cent to \$4,134.60. REUTERS

Raw sugar at 4-week high on market deficit fears



London: Raw sugar futures rose to a four-week high as adverse weather in several countries reinforced expectations that the market could shift into deficit in the 2026/27 season. Raw sugar was up 0.5 per cent at 15.09 cents per lb by 1344 GMT. White sugar rose 1.1 per cent to \$474.70 a tonne. REUTERS

India to grow world's 1st gene edited rice this winter

SETTING THE BALL ROLLING. ICAR is expected to sign an MoU this month with US-based Corteva, which holds the licence for CRISPR-Cas9 gene-editing tech

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

More than a year after its announcement, one of India's two gene-edited rice varieties is set to be planted in the upcoming rabi season for seed multiplication. The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) is expected to sign a memorandum of understanding (MoU) this month with the US-based Corteva, which holds the license for the CRISPR-Cas9 gene-editing technology. Highly placed sources said that ICAR had received 2 of the 3 approvals, including one from the Ministry of External Affairs, required to sign the MoU with Corteva; once the third one is received, the agreement will be signed.

The signing of the MoU will pave the way for the commercial release of "Pusa DST Rice 1", developed by ICAR's New Delhi-based Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI). "First, the MoU will be signed with Corteva and the next will be with the US-based MIT/Broad institute, which has the patent over the CRISPR-Cas12a tool," said a top official. The CRISPR-Cas12a tool was used to develop DRR Dhan 100 (Kamala), developed by the Hyderabad-based Indian Institute of Rice Research.

SEED MULTIPLICATION On May 4, 2025, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan announced the breakthrough of ICAR's scientists in which, for the first time, two rice varieties had been developed using



TO BE SIGNED SOON. ICAR has received 2 of the 3 approvals, including one from the Ministry of External Affairs, required to sign the MoU with Corteva

gene editing technology. Sources said that IARI had already kept about 2 tonnes of Pusa DST Rice 1, which is sufficient for starting seed multiplication in the upcoming

rabi season, with transplanting around November. Pusa DST Rice 1 is derived from MTU1010, which is suitable for rabi season in the southern States. Since

MTU1010 is sensitive to several abiotic stresses, including drought and salinity, scientists edited the SDNI mutant of the drought and salt tolerance (DST) gene. It

was tested in multilocation field trials during 2023 and 2024. Pusa DST Rice 1 exhibits an average yield of 2,493, 3,508 and 3731 kg/ha (under three different conditions) against MTU 1010's 1,912 kg/ha under coastal salinity stress, 3,199 kg/ha under inland salinity stress and 3,254kg/ha under alkalinity condition. ICAR recommends Pusa DST Rice 1 to be grown in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal.

AI-DESIGNED ENZYMES Before the MoU was signed with ICAR, Corteva signed a long-term humanitarian licensing agreement. Announcing the partnership, the In-

ternational Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics (Icrisat) on August 3 said it had secured long-term access to CRISPR-Cas9 in order to deploy gene editing, one of the world's most transformative new technologies, across smallholder Asian and African farms. Scientists said there is no issue while using the patented tool for research, but due to the Intellectual Property Rights of the technology, any commercialisation of new varieties from that research is prohibited, unless the patent holder or its licensee agrees to it. On the other hand, the ICAR scientists, led by Kutubuddin Ali Molla, showed that AI-designed enzymes could accurately edit plant DNA, enabling gene knockout, base editing and prime editing in crops.

'India can source 20% of gold demand domestically by 2047'

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

India has the potential to source up to 20 per cent of its annual gold demand of 800-850 tonnes from domestic mining through supportive policy measures, according to the World Gold Council's report *Swarnim Udaan 2047*. Over the past 10 years, the government has issued 18 composite licences and six mining licences across eight States, covering 14,632 hectares. These blocks collectively represent about 146 tonnes of gold-bearing ore containing an estimated 270 tonnes of the metal. Currently, India produces only about 1.6 tonnes of gold an-

nually. Building on this momentum, India's first large-scale private gold mine since Independence, the Jonnagiri gold project in Andhra Pradesh, commenced production in 2026. Developed by Geomysore Services with support from Deccan Gold Mines and Thiriveni Earthmovers, the project has attracted investment exceeding ₹400 crore and is expected to produce up to one tonne of gold annually. **GEOLOGICAL SIMILARITIES** Sachin Jain, Regional CEO India, WGC, said India could source up to 20 per cent of its gold requirement from domestic mines by 2047 and emerge as the "Jeweller of

the World" if policy reforms, investments and industry collaboration continue to gain momentum. India shares geological similarities with China, which transformed itself from a major importer into the world's largest gold producer over the past two decades, he said. To drive the implementation of the recommendations outlined in the report, the WGC announced the formation of three task forces focused on gold financialisation, mining and manufacturing, and consumer development. It also proposed the creation of a National Gold Board to bring policy co-ordination under a single institutional framework.

More rain forecast for Assam, Meghalaya

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

Heavy to very heavy rainfall, with isolated spells of extremely heavy rain, will continue to pound flood-hit Assam and Meghalaya over the next two days. With the monsoon now firmly focused on the eastern flank, most other regions are set to witness a relative easing of rainfall. The shift also signals a weakening of the system after it unleashed some of the heaviest rain across Central and West India. On Tuesday morning, the monsoon trough — the crucial low-pressure corridor that channels monsoon moisture from the seas — extended from Anupgarh through Delhi, Lucknow, Daltonganj and Mur-

shidabad across Rajasthan, west Uttar Pradesh and Jharkhand, before stretching eastwards towards Manipur. Its present alignment will funnel moisture predominantly into East and North-East India. Accordingly, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast fairly widespread to widespread rainfall accompanied by thunderstorms and lightning over Arunachal Pradesh for one day, Assam and Meghalaya for the three days, and Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura for six days. **WESTERN DISTURBANCE** In North-West India, another active monsoon zone, a fresh western disturbance in the form of an upper-air trough has moved into cent-

As the monsoon shifts focus to the East, rainfall is expected to ease over most other regions

ral Pakistan. Cyclonic circulations continue to persist over north-east Rajasthan, south Uttar Pradesh, north-west Bihar, north-east Assam and the hill districts of West Bengal. Under their influence, the IMD has forecast isolated heavy rainfall over Jammu-Kashmir-Ladakh and west Uttar Pradesh for the next three days, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand for six days, east Uttar Pradesh for four days, and east Rajasthan for four days from Sunday. The North-East will continue to bear the brunt of the

monsoon. Isolated heavy rainfall is forecast over Arunachal Pradesh for three days from Wednesday, Assam and Meghalaya for six days, and Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura for five days. In Central India, isolated heavy rainfall is likely over Madhya Pradesh for three days from Sunday, while Chhattisgarh is expected to receive heavy rain for six days beginning Tuesday. **WEST COAST RAINS** Along the West Coast, fairly widespread to widespread rainfall is expected over the Konkan and Goa for the next six days. Madhya Maharashtra, east Gujarat, Marathwada, Saurashtra and Kutch are also likely to receive isolated to scattered showers during the period.

Fishworkers flag concerns over draft changes to Merchant Shipping Act

V Sajeev Kumar
Kochi

Voicing concern over the proposed amendments to the Merchant Shipping Act, the Kerala Fishworkers' Co-ordination Committee has urged the Centre to hold consultations with coastal States and representatives of fishing communities before finalising the rules. A transparent and inclusive consultation process would help address genuine concerns and result in a more practical, balanced and widely accepted policy, said Charles George, President of the committee. In a representation to the Secretary, Union Ministry of Fisheries, George said that the manner in which the draft was prepared was itself a matter of concern. Instead of consulting the governments of coastal States and

recognised fishworkers' organisations, the Centre had held discussions through the fisheries departments with only selected stakeholders. Given the far-reaching implications of the proposed regulations, wider consultations with the State governments and representatives of the fishing communities are essential, he said. **SMALL-SCALE FISHING** George noted that around three lakh fishing vessels operate within India's Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ), the overwhelming majority engaged in traditional and small-scale fishing. Industrial fishing is not the dominant mode of operation, with the sector remaining largely labour-intensive. However, the draft appears to place disproportionate emphasis on industrial fishing which, he warned, could eventually lead to the

concentration of the sector in the hands of a few large operators. He also objected to the proposal for introducing access passes for fishing vessels operating beyond territorial waters, saying it could affect traditional fishers. The committee said the country's fishing fleet is dominated by traditional wooden vessels. In Kerala alone, thousands of small fishing canoes, including recently introduced thermocol canoes, support the livelihood of a large number of fishers. The draft, it said, failed to reflect these ground realities and overlooked the need to safeguard traditional fishing communities. George further alleged that although collisions involving fishing vessels were frequent in Kerala waters, the draft regulations did not adequately address this critical safety concern.

Go long on aluminium futures if price breaches ₹350

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Aluminium futures (₹349/kg), after losing about 15 per cent in June, gained 3.6 per cent in July. While the trend has not turned positive yet, there are signs that we are likely to see a breakout soon.

COMMODITY CALL.

The contract rebounded from the support at ₹327 in early July. And towards the end of last month, it formed a higher base at ₹335. The rally since the beginning of this week has taken the price above the 21-day moving average. While these are positive signs, aluminium futures ought to break out of ₹350 to confirm a bullish trend reversal. A breach of ₹350 would open the door for a rally to the ₹358-360 resistance band. A rally past this could lift the contract to ₹365. On the other hand, if the price drops from the current level of ₹348 on the back of the resistance at ₹350, it could drop to ₹335. As it stands, there is a bullish bias and so, the chances for the breakout of ₹350 are high.



TRADE STRATEGY Go long on aluminium futures if the price decisively breaches the resistance at ₹350. Target and stop-loss can be ₹365 and ₹342, respectively.

Tea Board launches tasting courses at Darjeeling centre

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Tea Board India on Monday launched tea tasting courses at its Darjeeling Tea Research and Development Centre (DTRDC) in Kurseong, aiming to strengthen the country's tea sector through structured skill development and professional education. The initiative seeks to create a pool of professionally trained tasters and sommeliers to support quality enhancement, tea appreciation, value-addition, branding and the global competitiveness of Indian teas, the Board said in a release. The programme also aims to promote tea literacy among the youth and generate employment opportunities in the industry. The courses have been de-

veloped with the support of the Agriculture Skill Council of India (ASCI), an awarding body recognised by the National Council for Vocational Education and Training (NCVET) under the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, in line with the Centre's push for skill-based education and industry-oriented learning. The curriculum for two courses — a 60-hour certificate programme and a 210-hour advanced programme — was formulated by a committee comprising representatives from the Department of Commerce, the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, subject experts and industry professionals. **FIRST BATCH** The inaugural batch features a 60-hour certificate programme, 'Essentials of Tea

Sommelier', designed to impart knowledge on tea appreciation, professional tea tasting, blending techniques and emerging trends in the tea industry. Speaking on the occasion, C Murugan, Deputy Chairman, Tea Board India, said the initiative would help build a skilled workforce capable of improving tea quality, strengthening scientific sensory evaluation and quality assurance systems, and promoting tea appreciation among consumers. The participants will receive hands-on training in tea cultivation, manufacturing, professional tasting methodologies, sensory evaluation, grading, blending, tea etiquette and industry best practices through classroom sessions, practical demonstrations and experiential learning, the Board said.

SEA delegation to participate in 'Soy Connex 2026' in Chicago

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

A delegation from the Solvent Extractors' Association of India (SEA) will attend 'Soy Connex 2026' in Chicago from August 5 to 7. Hosted by the US Soybean Export Council (USSEC), the event brings the global soy industry together, drawing hundreds of leaders from around the world to exchange ideas, plan open markets, and for future business. The delegation is expected to engage with leading US soybean industry stakeholders and participate in discussions on global soybean supply-demand and market signals, the 2026 US soybean crop, sustainability, food security, consumer trends and the evolving role of soy in the



global food landscape.

WIN-WIN CHANCE Quoting Sanjeev Asthana, President of SEA, a media statement said, "The primary aim is to explore win-win opportunities that can deliver greater value to farmers, industry and consumers in both countries." He said the US tour is an opportunity to build bridges between two major agricultural economies and explore how technology, innovation, sustainability and trade can work together. BV Mehta,

Executive Director of SEA, said: "The delegation will use the US tour to gain deeper insights into the global soybean market and explore opportunities for stronger India-US engagement. Our focus is not only on trade, but on creating long-term value for the entire agri-food chain." The SEA delegation includes Sanjeev Asthana; BV Mehta; Angshu Mallick, Executive Deputy Chairman, AWL Agri Business Ltd; Vidya Bhushan, Head-Edible Oils, Bunge India Pvt Ltd; Garima Jain, Director, Waseda Global Pvt Ltd; Pra-deep Krishna Chandrasekar, MD, SKM Animal Feeds and Foods (I) Pvt Ltd; Kanubhai J Thakkar, MD, Gokul Agro Resources Ltd; and Saurab Mehta, Joint MD, Kriti Nutrients Ltd.

Bayer launches 'Xivana Smart' for horti crops

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Bayer has launched 'Xivana Smart', its latest fungicide innovation designed to protect high-value horticultural crops from diseases, such as downy mildew and late blight. Powered by the new active ingredient in FRAC group 49, Xivana Smart delivers superior disease control in grapes, cucurbits, potatoes and tomatoes, helping farmers safeguard crop quality, improve productivity and maximise returns. Downy mildew and late blight are among the most destructive diseases affecting horticultural crops, often accounting for nearly half of farmers' crop protection expenditure.

Monoculture impacting Punjab's soil health, says study

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

A study by the Punjab Agricultural University has found that the continuous rice-wheat monoculture in Punjab is associated with soil degradation. In a written reply in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday, Union Minister of State for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Bhagirath Choudhary said repeated puddling, intensive tillage, the absence of legumes or green manuring, and continuous monocropping have contributed to soil degradation. Puddling during rice transplanting disrupts soil aggregation, reduces porosity and increases sub-surface compaction, affecting soil health in the absence of appropriate management practices. However, these effects are largely reversible through scientifically recom-



RICE-WHEAT IMPACT. Repeated puddling, intensive tillage, absence of legumes or green manuring, and continuous mono-cropping have contributed to soil degradation

mended practices such as crop rotation, inclusion of legumes, balanced fertilizer application, integrated nutrient management, use of organic manure and crop residue incorporation, he said. The area under rice in Punjab increased from 29.69 lakh hectares (lh) in 2021-22 to 32.68 lh in 2025-26, while wheat acreage remained

largely stable at 35.25 lh and 34.58 lh, respectively. During the same period, the share of maize, pulses and oilseeds in the State's cropped area declined from 8.6 per cent to 6.2 per cent. In contrast, horticultural crops, including fruits and vegetables, increased their share from 6.3 per cent to 7.2 per cent, indicating only modest diversification as the

rice-wheat system continues to dominate, Choudhary said. **WATER GUZZLERS** Replying to a separate question on the cultivation of water-intensive crops in water-stressed regions, Choudhary said rice, sugarcane, cotton and jute together occupy about 62.7 million hectares, nearly one-third of India's gross cropped area. Recognising the need to align cropping patterns with local water availability, the Indian Council of Agricultural Research assessed the cultivation of major water-intensive crops against rainfall and water resources. The assessment found that about 2.89 million hectares of rice are grown in 68 districts receiving less than 650 mm of annual rainfall, accounting for 5.67 per cent of the country's total rice area of about 51 million hectares.

‘10-km radius buffer for mining applies to all wetland reserves’

FOR PARITY. Mining near such areas requires wildlife panel approval: Supreme Court

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The direction banning mining activities within a 10-km radius of the Asan wetland conservation reserve, a Ramsar site in Uttarakhand, would apply to other wetland conservation reserves across the country for the sake of parity, clarified the Supreme Court on Tuesday.

Justice Joyimalya Bagchi made the oral observation, “Wherever it is a community or a wetland conservation reserve, Asan (directions) will be applied. Wetlands are in a different category... We are conscious of the extent to which we are laying down parity. It is not that it (directions) would apply to Madhya Pradesh or would apply to West Bengal only...”

BUFFER DISPUTE

Justice Bagchi, on the Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, made the remark while hearing an application filed by the State of Himachal Pradesh arguing that the 10-km radius restriction imposed in Uttarakhand



APPLICABILITY OF ORDER. Wherever it is a community or a wetland conservation reserve, Asan (directions) will be applied, said the top court. JOTHI RAMALINGAM B

should not apply to it.

Himachal Pradesh said that the Asan reserve did not come within its territory. The State’s counsel said that there was no need for a buffer zone outside the reserve area, unlike in the case of national parks and sanctuaries.

The trigger for the Himachal Pradesh plea was a pending petition in the State High Court arguing that since Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh were adjoining States, the February 14, 2014, direction of the apex court would extend to the latter also.

Chief Justice Surya Kant said there was no argument

that the Himalayan terrain was passing through both adjoining States.

EXPERT REVIEW

The apex court, however, said that whether the Asan reserve was located in Himachal Pradesh or not was a question of fact.

The Bench directed the standing committee of the National Board of Wildlife or the Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change to determine the facts.

It underscored that if the wetland conservation reserve was found to be in Himachal Pradesh, the Febru-

ary 14, 2024, ban on mining in Uttarakhand would also extend to Himachal Pradesh.

If, on the other hand, the reserve is not found to be within Himachal Pradesh’s territory, the decision on whether or not to allow mining would be taken by the competent authority in accordance with the law.

The same set of directions must govern the entire Himalayan terrain. “The only exception can be if an expert committee says the wetland reserve is not in your State,” the CJ addressed Himachal Pradesh.

On February 14, 2024, the court passed an interim order that “no mining activities would be carried out within a 10 km radius of the Asan wetland conservation reserve without the project proponent obtaining permission from the Standing Committee of the National Board of Wildlife and/or MoEF&CC. The additional reason that weighs with us in issuing this direction is due to the importance given to the wetland, which was declared to be a Ramsar site under the Ramsar Convention.”

SC mandates SOPs to curb digital arrests, ensure refunds

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday passed a detailed order directing the Centre, the States, the Reserve Bank of India and the telecom authorities to prepare standard operating procedures (SOPs) to curb ‘digital arrest’ scams and operationalise mechanisms to hear the grievances of the victims, initiate criminal action through zero FIRs against cyber fraudsters, and return the monetary losses of those defrauded in a time-bound manner.

The court referred to a status report submitted by the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C), Ministry of Home Affairs, which said complaints received on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal against digital arrests had substantially reduced from 1.23 lakh in 2024 to 58,249 in 2025, and further down to 16,377 for the period ending June 30, 2026.

However, the court said though the statistics were “certainly encouraging”, it was still essential to monitor the situation.

“As per the fourth status report, a data-sharing MoU between the Reserve Bank Innovation Hub and I4C was executed on May 11, 2026. Additionally, the Money Restoration Mechanism Portal has 57 participating banks and covers all 36 States and Union Territories, with restoration completed in 36,290 cases, involving an aggregate amount of ₹18.05 crore,” the court noted.

The court said the e-Zero FIR mechanism was functional in 19 States, while only



identified 238 victims, 67 first-layer bank accounts, transactions of approximately ₹80 crore, and conducted searches at 93 locations across 16 States,” the court said.

BANKING REFORMS

The Bench recorded that the Inter-Departmental Committee had requested the CBI to examine the feasibility of lowering the existing threshold of ₹10 crore and take up cases involving the same organised network in which the cumulative fraud crossed that threshold.

In a series of interim directions, the court directed the RBI to prepare and circulate within four weeks a SOP for banks for placing temporary debit holds on mule accounts linked to money laundering activities and cyber-enabled

fraud. A copy of the SOP shall be furnished to the Registrars General of the High Courts. The States and Union Territories were directed to frame modules for grievance redressal and money restoration as per the Ministry of Home Affairs’ SOP concerning the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal and Cyber RMS within four weeks.

The court said the next status report would include State-wise and bank-wise details of data grievances registered and disposed of, summary restoration orders issued and summary restorations completed, and the amounts restored.

The court said cases dealing with freezing of bank accounts arising out of cyber-enabled financial frauds ought to be dealt with expeditiously.

IIT-Madras AI4Bharat and Josh Talks AI launch evaluation platform tailored for Indian AI models

Our Bureau
Chennai

AI4Bharat, an initiative from IIT-Madras alongside Josh Talks AI has launched Voice of India, a multimodal AI Evaluation platform dedicated to evaluating AI systems against real-world Indian conditions.

The platform will enable governments, enterprises, researchers and AI developers to independently assess how AI systems perform across Indian languages, accents, dialects and deployment environments.

It was launched at an event in New Delhi in the presence of S Krishnan, Secretary,

The platform will enable govts, firms and developers assess how AI systems perform across Indian languages

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

Rather than relying solely on performance metrics or benchmarks developed for Western contexts, the platform provides scientifically rigorous, India-specific evaluations that reflect how AI is actually used across the country, a statement from

the parties, said. According to the joint statement, the Voice of India AI Evaluation Platform will be a new layer on top of AI models, compute infrastructure and language technologies. It will evaluate models across voice, speech translation, long-document processing, including accuracy, cultural appropriateness across Indian languages and legal reasoning.

ROBUST EVALUATION

“With AI systems becoming more deeply integrated into society, rigorous evaluation becomes as important as model development itself. Through Voice of India, we hope to provide the research community, industry and

policymakers with scientifically robust evaluation frameworks that reflect India’s linguistic diversity. India has a unique opportunity not only to build AI for the world, but also to help define how the world measures it,” said Mitesh Khapra, AI4Bharat, IIT Madras.

“The next frontier in AI isn’t building larger models. It’s building better ways to measure whether they actually work. The Voice of India AI Evaluation Platform aims to create independent, transparent evaluation infrastructure that helps AI builders understand where models succeed, where they fail and why,” Shobhit Banga, Co-Founder, Josh Talks AI.

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Udhayanidhi Stalin held, released on station bail

Press Trust of India
Thanjavur

DMK leader Udhayanidhi Stalin, who was arrested on Tuesday for a double-meaning insulting remark, was released on station bail following questioning at Sengipatti near here, police sources said.

Udhayanidhi was accorded a warm welcome by DMK workers outside the police station.

After he was arrested from his Chennai residence about 11 am, he was brought to the Sengipatti police station, about 27 km from here, and questioned in the presence of senior police officials, sources added.

Following the completion of the questioning about the alleged objectionable remark during a protest by the DMK at Thanjavur on the Cauvery water issue, he was released on station bail as per the State government’s submission in the Madras High Court.

The questioning lasted

for about an hour, and he was set free approximately 9 hours following his arrest.

Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam escalated its protest against Udhayanidhi’s alleged offensive remark by filing complaints with the local police and the National Commission for Women.

DMK workers resorted to flash strikes across the State, and road-roko demonstrations were also held, strongly condemning the arrest.

DMK President MK Stalin chaired a meeting at the party headquarters to decide on the next course of action, as the Assembly session is set to begin on August 5.

Party leaders, including EV Velu, KN Nehru and TRB Rajaa, were among the prominent DMK leaders who gathered at the spot. Former Ministers PK Sekarbabu and Ma Subramanian were among those who reportedly accompanied Udhayanidhi in the police vehicle.

1.48 b promotional calls blocked in Q1: TRAI report

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Nearly 13.16 billion promotional calls originated via the dedicated 140 series between April and June of 2026, a TRAI report said on Tuesday.

It added that 1.48 billion calls were blocked after verification with registered do-not-disturb preferences of the customers.

As per the quarterly report listing out the action against Unsolicited Commercial Communications (UCC) during the quarter, commercial SMS originating from registered senders/telemarketers stood at about 248.06 billion, with 7.3 billion promotional SMSs blocked after verification with registered DND preferences of the customers.



Spirit of Samudra Manthan



Strength of Progress

EXTRACT OF FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND THREE MONTHS ENDED 30TH JUNE, 2026

ONGC: Delivering Energy, Creating Value

▶ Gross Revenue ₹46,460 Crore in Q1 FY’27

▶ Net Profit ₹17,034 Crore

▶ ₹3,998 Crore revenue from New Well Gas

▶ Spudding of First Deepwater Well in Mahanadi Basin under Samudra Manthan

▶ 2 New Discoveries strengthening India’s energy future

▶ ₹40,000+ Crore strategic investment in Western Offshore assets



By order of the Board

Sd/-

Anupam Agarwal
Director (Finance)
(DIN: 09601339)

Place: New Delhi
Date: 04th August, 2026

The results can be accessed through the following link or scan:
<https://ongcindia.com/web/eng/about-ongc/performance/financial/results>

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